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[00:10:25] Memories, please take your seats. Head page. House is now in session. All persons not entitled to privileges of the floor, please retire to the gallery.

[00:10:45] The memos will rise and be laid in prayer by Reverend Mike Mason, Richmond, Virginia, and remain standing for the Pledge of Allegiance of the Flag of the United States of America, which will be laid by the Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring.

[00:11:01] Let us pray. Ever-present God, Lord, Leader, and Guide, may the work done here today be carried out so as to bring glory to you and thy creation. Keep before us that our enemies are not of flesh and blood, party, race, national origin, or voting district, or any human-generated distinctions, but bring us together.

[00:11:21] Our work is to overcome the rulers, the authorities, the spiritual forces of evil. Almighty God, clothe each person gathered here to carry out your work with a cloak of thy righteousness, a belt of truth, and shoes that will carry them to be victors for the cause of peace and prosperity for all the people of this commonwealth may virtue reign over oppression always and in

[00:11:47] always amen amen the members will answer the roll call by indicating their presence on the

[00:12:24] electronic voting board clerk will close the roll uh miss speaker quorum is present suing to house rule three i've examined and approved the journal house of delegates for february 10th 2026 motions of resolutions under rule 39 pursuant to the provisions of rule 40 are now in order does the Have any announcements or communications? No announcements or communications. Therefore, in this first portion of the morning opportunity to House Rule 40, Speaker requests you use your request to speak button for the agenda items listed for reference up on the voting board.

[00:13:02] The delegate from Rockingham, Delegate Runyon. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, joining in the gallery today is the Harrisonburg-Rockingham and Greater Augusta Association of Realtors. I ask they please stand. Look at them. They are so compliant and observant.

[00:13:21] serve, and good to see you all. As a trade association serving real estate professionals and affiliate members in the Rockingham and Augusta County area of the Shenandoah Valley of Virginia, the most beautiful part of the Commonwealth, the Harrisonburg-Rockingham and Greater Augusta Association of Realtors are dedicated to promoting ethics and professionalism in real estate business practices and advocating for the interests of all property owners to attain the American dream. I ask my fellow members to please join me in extending a warm

[00:13:48] House, welcome to these folks. Welcome, welcome to the Capitol today. The delegate from Arlington, Delegate Hope. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for a motion. Delegate, ask the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, members of the body, it's on behalf of the Arlington and Falls Church delegation that I rise today, and as I do so with a heavy heart to honor the life and legacy of a true titan of Arlington, Judge William T. Newman Jr., who passed away yesterday. A lifelong

[00:14:26] Arlingtonian Bill Newman's life was a testament to the progress of our community. Growing up in the Naught neighborhood, he witnessed the transition from segregation to integration firsthand, attending Hoffman-Bosbon before it was closed in 1964, following desegregation. He carried those lessons of justice and resilience throughout a career defined by a bunch of firsts.

[00:14:48] In 1987, Mr. Newman broke a century-long barrier when he was elected to the Arlington County Board, becoming the first African American to serve on that body since the Reconstruction era. On the board, one of his signature policies was establishing the county's Human Rights Commission, and he was known, Mr. Speaker, for advocating for public safety and resources for drug abuse. In 1990, he was elected as a chairman of the county board, becoming the first black person to hold that position in the 20th century. But he didn't just hold that seat. He led with vision, serving as chairman and eventually founding the Arlington

[00:15:25] Community Foundation to ensure that local philanthropy would always have a home. In 1983, he moved from the board chamber to the judge's chamber, Mr. Speaker, beginning a 30-year tenure on the 17th Judicial Circuit Court serving Arlington and Falls Church. In 2003, he became chief judge of the county circuit court until he retired from the bench in 2023. As chief judge, he was known for a unique brand of wisdom, one that balanced the strictness of law with a deep personal empathy. Perhaps this was because Bill understood the human story so well.

[00:16:03] Many of us knew him not just as a judge, but a gifted actor who graced the stages of regional theaters and appeared in film and television. He knew that every person walking into his courtroom had a narrative, and he treated those narratives with dignity that they deserved.

[00:16:20] Judge Newman's life was a master class in public service. He was a trailblazer, a jurist, an artist, and a mentor. Arlington is a better, more just place because he lived. Therefore, Mr. Speaker, I move that when we adjourn today, we do so in the memory and the honor of the Honorable William T. Newman, Jr. The delegate from Arlington, Delegate Hope, moves that when the House adjourns today, it do so in the honor and memory of the Honorable William T. Newman,

[00:16:51] Jr. All those in favor shall rise. The motion is agreed to. Delegate from Rockingham, Delegate Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction.

[00:17:07] Delegate on the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Ladies and gentlemen of the House, today our invocation was given by Reverend Mike Maighton. He's a lifelong Virginian, and he currently serves as a pastor of Bonaire United Methodist Church. He has served United Methodist Churches across the Commonwealth, Newport News, Barumsville, Winchester, and Stevens City.

[00:17:28] He graduated from York High School in historic Yorktown, and he holds degrees from Christopher Newport College and Wesley Theological Seminary. For 30 years, he's been married to his wife, Cheryl, and they have a daughter, Malia. I ask that you would join me in giving a warm house welcome.

[00:17:52] Welcome to the Capitol, Reverend Maiden, and thank you for that lovely prayer this morning. A delegate from Richmond City, Delegate Carr. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, sir. I rise for an introduction and motion.

[00:18:10] Mr. Speaker, joining us today in the House Gallery are members of the James River Association. I would ask them to stand and welcome them. This year marks the 50th anniversary of the JRA, founded in 1976 in response to community concern for the health of the river.

[00:18:29] That same year, the Kepone contamination of the river made the title James unsafe and resulted in an unprecedented 13-year fishing ban, underscoring the fragility of the river where this nation began. The James River is America's founding river.

[00:18:46] It's Virginia's largest watershed. It provides drinking water for over one-third of Virginians, and it is an economic, ecological, and recreational cornerstone of the state. And the James River Association is the only nonprofit solely dedicated to protecting and restoring the James River and its tributaries.

[00:19:07] James River Association's work spans science-based restoration, education, community engagement, and advocacy to protect and improve water quality. James River Association works to connect tens of thousands of students and Virginians to the river through hands-on, river-based education.

[00:19:24] The James River's health has steadily improved and was the recipient of the International River Prize celebrating excellence in river management and restoration. With that, I would like to call HJR 111 out of order, Mr. Speaker.

[00:19:44] Clerk will report a resolution. House Joint Resolution 111, commanding the James River Association. Delegate from Richmond City, Doug Ackar. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I would like to make a motion to move the adoption of House Joint Resolution 111. Delegate from Richmond City, Delegate Carr moves that the House adopt House Joint Resolution number 111.

[00:20:04] All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The resolution is a B-2. Congratulations. Delegate from Middlesex, Delegate Hodges.

[00:20:21] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for a motion. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Ladies and gentlemen of the House, I rise today to honor the memory of the Honorable Marie Walls. Until yesterday, she served as the Matthews County Commonwealth Attorney.

[00:20:41] Matthews was a dedicated leader in our community, and her passing has left a significant void. She was more than just a lawyer. She was a fierce advocate for justice and a tireless supporter of those in need. Born and raised in Virginia, Marie devoted her life to public service, Mr. Speaker.

[00:21:02] Her impressive career began as a legal aid attorney, where she provided important assistance to individuals facing difficult circumstances. As a prosecutor, she worked diligently to ensure the safety of our citizens and to uphold the law with integrity.

[00:21:24] Marie also made a lasting impact, Mr. Speaker, on the lives of our children through her role as the Executive Director of the Child Abuse Program at Children's Hospital of King's Daughters. In this capacity, she was instrumental in helping children receive the care and support they needed during challenging times, ensuring their voices were heard.

[00:21:51] In her role as Commonwealth's Attorney for Matthews County, Marie exemplified the ideals of public service. She was respected for her hard work and commitment to making our community a safer place for all.

[00:22:10] Outside her professional achievements, Marie was a warm and kind individual, cherished by her friends and neighbors. We will feel her absence deeply. As we remember Marie Walls today, let us honor her legacy by continuing to serve our communities with the same dedication and compassion she showed throughout her life.

[00:22:38] Her commitment to helping others will inspire us all. So, Mr. Speaker, as we adjourn today, I move that we adjourn in the memory of the Honorable Marie Walls. I will take a point of personal privilege here.

[00:22:54] Marie Walls was a friend of mine. I knew her very well. She was a strong advocate for the Commonwealth of Virginia in her role as Commonwealth Attorney, and I will move the delegate from Middlesex, Delegate Hodges moves that, when the House adjourned today, that we do so in the honor and memory of Marie Wallace.

[00:23:13] All those in favor shall rise. The motion is agreed to. The delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Hayes. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for a motion. The delegate has the floor.

[00:23:29] Thank you so much, Mr. Speaker. I move that on page 66, that House Bill 1250 be referred to the Committee of Appropriations. The Delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Hayes, moves that HB 1250 found on page 66 be re-referred to the Committee on Appropriations.

[00:23:45] All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. Bills are re-referred to the Committee on Appropriations. Delegate from Hanover, Delegate Fowler. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an announcement. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Members of the House, it's 7 a.m. tomorrow morning.

[00:24:05] The Virginia Sportsman's Caucus will begin on the seventh floor north. And we have Osiris Baird from Delta Waterfowl is going to be our guest speaker. So again, I'm hoping you'll be able to attend.

[00:24:23] And again, it's 7 a.m., seventh floor north. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The delegate from Roanoke City, Delegate Rasul. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for the purpose of an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:24:40] Ladies and gentlemen of the House, I'd ask the students from Virginia Tech Carillion School of Medicine to please rise. We are happy to have them with us today. The students came to speak to us as representatives of the Medical Society of Virginia to advocate for a variety of different bills, including student loan repayment, medical downcoding, non-complete clauses, and workplace violence.

[00:25:05] They really squeezed us, Mr. Speaker, in their lobbying. It was great to visit with them this past fall. They were smiling. They're still generally smiling as they're going into their spring of their first year in medical school. I hope we wish them not only the best of luck throughout the rest of medical school, but give them a warm house welcome. Thank you. Thank you and welcome to the captain. Take note of the ones that didn't stand up because they'll probably be. You have to take care of them so get them back later. Delegate from

[00:25:43] Virginia Beach, Delegate Tater. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. It is a high honor for me to introduce a very special guest, former delegate and current Virginia Beach Sheriff, Rocky Holcomb, who's with us today on the floor. Sheriff Holcomb's His career began in 1991 as a deputy sheriff recruit.

[00:26:05] Over more than three decades of service, Sheriff Holcomb has worked in every division of the Virginia Beach Sheriff's Office, leading the emergency response team, commanding criminal intelligence and even founding the K-9 unit for narcotics and explosives detection.

[00:26:22] He also achieved the special distinction of becoming the first sheriff in Virginia Beach history to rise through every rank to become elected sheriff. Since being sworn in as sheriff in September 2023, he has remained focused on his trust philosophy: transparency, respect, unity, service and training.

[00:26:42] Sheriff Holcomb's goal is clear: to ensure the Virginia Beach Sheriff's Office remains a gold standard for public safety and professional integrity. But Rocky's commitment to service extends far beyond the badge. He is a United States Marine Corps veteran, he served our community in the Virginia House of delegates and on the virginia beach city council he's a graduate of regent university and a west point leadership course he's a devoted husband and father and a lifelong resident of the great city of virginia beach please join me in giving sheriff rocky holcomb a warm house welcome

[00:27:28] welcome back home former delegate former delegate rocky holcomb the delegate from fairfax delegate watts thank you mr speaker i rise for an introduction delegate has the floor thank Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Today we have members of the League of Women Voters of Virginia in the gallery, if they would rise so that we might greet them. They are celebrating their Day of Advocacy League Day. Forged from the suffragette movement, the League of Women Voters of Virginia will be 106 years old this year. They have a legacy of fighting for the rights of voters

[00:28:06] and broadening the franchise of voting for all eligible Virginians. Whether they are advocating for voters' rights or providing nonpartisan information on elections through their voter 411.org system, the league remains a champion for voters. The LWV of Virginia has 2,000 members throughout the Commonwealth and 15 local leagues. They have expanded outreach to young people by starting a youth council for members 16 to 24 years old and establishing league chapters on

[00:28:42] college campuses, including George Mason, William & Mary, and Mary Baldwin. Please join me in welcoming the League of Women Voters of Virginia. Welcome, welcome to the Capitol today. Delegate from Buckingham, Delegate Garrett. Thank you, Mr. Speaker, rise for the introduction. Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, I'd ask that the student interns and Dr. Dan Palazzolo from the University of Richmond, please stand for this introduction. Mr. Speaker, I take inspiration from my friend

[00:29:22] and colleague across the aisle, Delegate Hayes, who yesterday had the privilege of introducing norfolk state university so i'll start with this i am spider-born and i'm spider-bred and when i die i'll be spider dead mr speaker 33 years ago i was a student at the university of richmond and at that time i met a young woman and i thought very highly of her and i remember very distinctly having the privilege of having a conversation about who our favorite professor was mr speaker and she said well it's got to be dr palazzolo and i said well why and she said because he's cute So that sort of stuck with me. Both of us had more hair then, Mr. Speaker.

[00:30:01] I asked Dr. Palazzolo in the course of preparing for this introduction how many states he had had students who interned here at the General Assembly from, Mr. Speaker. He essentially said he wasn't sure if he had all 50 yet, but it was probably close. They've also had students from dozens of nations this year, to include the United Kingdom and Pakistan, who worked with members here in this august body.

[00:30:22] I will tell you, Mr. Speaker, the University of Richmond and professors like Dr. Palazzolo changed my life for the better. It's a little known fact that I used to sound just like Buddy Fowler until I got rid of my rural and learned to speak English. So with all of these things in mind, all right, sort of a little bit English with all these things in mind.

[00:30:40] And by the way, if you haven't had an intern from U of R, please contact me or Dr. Palazzolo. I also want to take this moment to single out my intern this year, C.J., the California kid, Blastos, who we affectionately call Junior. But if you hadn't had a U.R. intern, you should have one. They're amazing.

[00:30:57] They're going to change the world for the better, Mr. Speaker. So I ask you to join me in welcoming these amazing students and Dr. Dan Palazzolo from the University of Richmond. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol Day. And I have an intern up there, too. See that?

[00:31:18] The delegate from Loudoun County, Delegate Reeser. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for a request and a motion. The delegate has the floor. I request that HJR 77 on page 46 be pulled up out of order and speak into that motion.

[00:31:34] Clerk will report a resolution. House Joint Resolution 77, designated the day of the spring equinox in 2026 in each, that's.

[00:32:03] Do you want to take the motion up out of order? Yes sir, that was. Okay, we'll take it up out of order.

[00:32:28] Mr. Speaker, the delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. So, Mr. Speaker, this is not a memorial or commanding resolution, so this would be a recorded vote? This is a recorded vote. So people will need to be in their seats to cast their votes, Mr. Speaker? Correct. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:33:24] House Joint Resolution 77, found on page 46.

[00:34:10] This is a recorded vote to pull it out of the calendar first.

[00:34:23] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 95, nos 0. Ayes 95, nos 0. The bill is now before us, and the clerk will report the resolution. Ms. Speaker, members of the House, House Short Resolution 77 designated the day of the spring equinox in 2026 and in each succeeding year as no ruse in Virginia.

[00:34:44] This Legislature Report Committee on Rules. Delegate from Loudoun County, Delegate Reeser. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, H.J.R. 77 established this day celebrating the Iranian New Year, which is called no ruse. No ruse literally means new day. It originated more than 3,000 years ago and is celebrated around the world on the spring equinox.

[00:35:04] Normally, I would speak to the rich traditions of the large Virginia diaspora here in the Commonwealth and throughout the U.S., but current events today dictate otherwise. As I said in subcommittee, in today's Iran, the regime has outlawed the act of celebrating altogether. So in a profound and courageous show of defiance, families of murdered protesters are celebrating instead of mourning the death of those who die, demanding basic human rights and freedom.

[00:35:31] Thousands have been killed and tens of thousands, Mr. Speaker, have been arrested or injured simply for wanting self-determination. So today I speak for the thousands of Iranian-Americans who live in the Commonwealth. I speak for the Virginians and the Americans, both in uniform and out, that have been murdered by the IRGC and its terrorist proxies.

[00:35:52] They deserve a voice, Mr. Speaker, and as an Iranian-American immigrant myself, I am honored to help be that voice. I hope that the new year brings a free Iran, and I hope that it is the will of this body to engross the bill and pass it to its third read.

[00:36:11] Shall the resolution be agreed to? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:36:31] Ayes, 94, no, 0, abstention, 1. Ayes, 94, no, 0, abstention, 1, the resolution is agreed to. The delegate from Grayson County, Delegate Cornett.

[00:36:52] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for a motion. Duncan has the floor. Mr. Speaker, I move that when the House adjourns today, it adjourned in the honor and memory of Master Corrections Officer Jeremy Lewis Hall. And I'd like to speak to that motion. That's the floor. Jeremy Hall lost his life in the line of duty at River North Correctional Center in Grayson County on November 17th of 25.

[00:37:12] He was a husband who loved his wife proudly, a father who treasured every opportunity to show his daughter the world, and a son and a friend whose steady presence meant more to people than he likely ever realized. Jeremy was a public servant whose life was defined not by titles, but by the way he showed up for the people around him.

[00:37:34] Corrections officers work in demanding places and sometimes in dangerous environments, often out of the public eye. Yet the safety of our communities depend on their service every single day. Jeremy Hall understood that responsibility, and he carried it with humility.

[00:37:51] He never sought recognition, and he was determined to do the job the right way. At his memorial, it was said that it is okay to remember him with both laughter and tears because a life that gives so much leaves behind both gratitude and grief. So, Mr. Speaker, there's an old saying that says the measure of a person is found in the quiet difference they make in the lives of others.

[00:38:15] By that measure, Jeremy Hall lived a life that mattered deeply to his family, to his fellow officers, and to the Commonwealth that he served. He was a son of Southwest Virginia, and his passing

continues to be felt not only by his family, but by an entire region that is proud to call him one of our own.

[00:38:32] Mr. Speaker, I ask that we keep the Hall family in our thoughts and prayers, and that when the House adjourns today, we do so in the honor and memory of Master Corrections Officer Jeremy Lewis Hall. The delegate from Grayson County, Delegate Cornett, moves that when the House adjourned today, it do so in the honor and memory of Master Corrections Officer Jeremy Lewis Hall.

[00:38:51] All those in favor shall rise. The motion is agreed to. Delegate from Henrico County, Delegate McQuinn. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for an introduction.

[00:39:09] Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mrs. Baker, today in the House Gallery, we are honored to have the members of the Virginia Sheriff Association with us for their legislative day. I ask that they will please stand at this time. Again, this is such an honor to introduce the sheriffs and deputies who have been participating in the Virginia Sheriff Association's legislative day, including a very close friend and sheriff of the city of Richmond, Sheriff Antoinette Irving from Richmond, and the president of the Virginia Sheriff Association.

[00:39:42] Established in 1933, the VSA is the only organization representing all of Virginia's sheriff, deputy sheriffs, and support personnel. VSA has almost 11,000 deputies and support staff members. Sheriffs are constitutional officers elected pursuant to Article 7, Section 4 of the Constitution of Virginia.

[00:40:05] They are the primary law enforcement agency in 86 Virginia counties. Virginia sheriffs are responsible for running all local jails in Virginia, which you don't want to know about. Sheriffs are responsible for the service of process and provide security for our judges and courts, keeping citizens safe during the judicial process.

[00:40:25] I ask that you would please join me at this time in providing a warm welcome and recognizing the men and women who each and every day serve our Commonwealth as sheriffs and deputy sheriffs. Thank you. Welcome.

[00:40:50] Welcome to the Capitol today. Delegate from Fauquier, Delegate Weber. Mr. Speaker, I rise for a motion. Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House adjourn in the honor and memory of James Hartman, and I would like to speak to that motion.

[00:41:09] Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, colleagues of the House, today I rise with profound respect and deep gratitude to honor the life of James Hartman. We called him Jimmy, a man whose life was a testament to service, to community, and to the quiet strength that defines the very best of Virginia's public servants. Jimmy Hartman was many things. A dedicated Falker County Sheriff's deputy with integrity, he served with integrity and heart over three decades, earning the respect of the

[00:41:48] community he protected every single day. A committed public servant on the town council and as vice mayor of Warrington, where he listened first, led humbly, and always placed the community above self. But titles and years of service alone do not capture the essence of the man he was.

[00:42:10] Jimmy was a true Virginian, not in the sense of formality or fanfare, but in who he was at his core. A person of quiet confidence, steady presence, and an ease about him that made everyone around him feel valued and heard. He carried himself with a humility that made leadership feel effortless and accessible. He wasn't one to broadcast his achievements.

[00:42:38] His leadership was evident in how people responded to him with trust, with warmth, and with respect. And that, perhaps more than any accolade, is the truest measure of his service. He was a man of the people, someone who understood that public life is not about advancing oneself, but about lifting others.

[00:43:03] He treated every constituent with dignity. He made space for differences of opinion without diminishing those who held them. In a world where debate can too often become division, Jimmy demonstrated that one can stand firmly for what they believe and still carry the respect and love of those who disagreed.

[00:43:23] That is a rare quality. That is what a life of service looks like, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I ask the members of this body to join me in honoring Jimmy, a servant, a leader, a neighbor, and a friend to so many.

[00:43:42] May his memory remind us of the power of quiet service, the strength of kindness and leadership, and the enduring impact of a life lived for others. Mr. Speaker, I move the House adjourn in the honor and memory of James Hartman. The delegate from Farquhar County, Delegate Webber, moves that when the House adjourned today, do so in the honor and memory of James Hartman.

[00:44:04] All those in favor shall rise. The motion is agreed to. Delegate from Rockingham, Delegate Runyon. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction. Elegan has the floor.

[00:44:20] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, in the gallery today, we have students from Stanton, Augusta, and Waynesboro Model General Assembly. I would ask them to please rise. The students that participate in this program demonstrate dedication and their desire to understand how the legislative process works, and it gives me great optimism for the future of the Commonwealth.

[00:44:41] Mr. Speaker and members of the body, I hope we do not show them any bad habits that they might learn today. The 48th Annual Model General Assembly is a community project of Stanton, Waynesboro, and Augusta County where students act as legislators in a mock state government and is sponsored by the Kiwanis Club of Stanton.

[00:45:01] I ask my fellow members to please join me in extending a warm house welcome to these students.

[00:45:16] Welcome, welcome, welcome to the Capitol today. One of y'all need to come and take his job. I saw a lot of volunteers. The delegate from Hanover, Delegate Wyatt. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Today we have students from Grace Christian School visiting Mr. Jefferson's Capitol.

[00:45:34] I would ask them to please rise. Grace Christian School is committed to constant pursuant of academic excellence, quality instruction, and providing the best learning experience for its students. The vision was established that this Christian and middle and high school in Hanover County began informally with good friends.

[00:45:55] And in 2013, they welcomed 34 students to its first class, graduating their first class in 2016. Since a capital expansion was just completed in 2023, they now welcome over 350 students to secondary education and continues to be a waiting list there.

[00:46:18] Grace Christian School's families, teachers, and staff are members of Hanover County, Henrico County, Chesterfield, the City of Richmond, King William, West Point, New Kent, Caroline, and Charles City Counties. I hope that members of the House will join me in welcoming the students of Grace Christian School and give them a warm house welcome.

[00:46:38] Thank you. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. The Delegate from Franklin County, Delegate Davis. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:46:53] I rise for introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. In the gallery today, we have friends from Empire Bakery of Rocky Mount. Would they please stand? Mr. Speaker, each member in this house today should have received a piece of cake that they make in Rocky Mount, my town.

[00:47:13] Empire Bakery's products are sold in 41 states, most notably in Kroger grocery stores. The company proudly employs 331 hardworking individuals and operates nine production lines. They specialize in producing retail-ready cakes, bars, cookies, brownies, and cupcakes that can be found on store shelves around the country.

[00:47:35] Members, please join me in extending a warm house welcome. Thank you. Welcome to the Capitol, and we'll see you tomorrow.

[00:47:52] The delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Leftwich. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I was wondering if the delegate from Franklin would yield for a question. Would a delegate yield for a question in this first morning hour? I will yield, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I haven't gotten my cake. I want to know where it is.

[00:48:10] It was good cake. He probably kept it. Delegate from Orange County, Delegate Hamilton. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for the purpose of an introduction. Delegate has the floor.

[00:48:25] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Seated in the gallery today, we have a group of exceptional young men from Woodbury Forest School. If they would please rise. I think they're coming in now. Located in central Virginia, Woodbury Forest is one of the premier boarding schools in the United States.

[00:48:41] The student body is made up of young men from 27 different states and 30 different countries. Known for its famed honor system and an outstanding college admissions record, the school has been educating young men since 1889.

[00:48:57] Please join me in giving them a warm House welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. So into House Rule 30, the journal shall reflect that the following members are away on pressing personal business.

[00:49:16] I'm going to leave from today's session, Delegates Knight and Converse Fowler. The clerk will announce the next order. Ms. Speaker, the second portion of the morning hours are for the announcement of member requests to move any legislation from uncontested to a regular. I'm only aware of one on page 43 of today's printed calendar under the category of resolutions uncontested.

[00:49:35] Delegate Askew's House Court Resolution 28 is out of the uncontested block over to the regular calendar. The third portion of the morning hour is reserved announcement member requests for legislation go by for the day, and if such, the motion by the Majority Leader.

[00:49:51] There are four that I'm aware of. Page 12 of today's calendar, House Bill's third reading, Delegate Downey's, House Bill 841, bye for the day. Page 25, House Bill's in second reading regular, that category, Delegate McClure's, House Bill 524, and Delegate Converse-Fowler's.

[00:50:12] House Bill 5 on page 26, both of those are bye for the day. And then in that same, the next category, resolutions uncontested. Delegate Askew's House Joint Resolution 28 that we just moved out of the block. It's also bye for the day.

[00:50:27] All of those requests are made by Delegate Tran. The Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that the legislation as announced by the clerk go bye for the day. The Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring moves that the legislation as announced by the clerk go bye for the day. As many in favor of the motion, say aye. Those opposed, no.

[00:50:44] The motion is agreed to. The clerk will announce the next order. And the fourth and final portion of the morning hour reserved for member requests for points of personal privilege, Kindly use your request to speak to Martin to get into the queue. Calendar for today, Wednesday, February 11th, 2026.

[00:50:59] Approximately 100 bills and resolutions, run over 48 pages to be dispensed with today. First category, House bills on third reading, final passage uncontested calendar, about 20 bills on that, they are as follows. House Bill 701, House Bill 756, 813, 815, 893, 902, 921.

[00:51:20] House Bills 1,007, 1,086, 1,097, 1,145, HB 1157, 1,191. Over on page 6, we continue. Third reading, uncontested counter block. House Bills 1214, 1226, 1288, 1290, 1336, 1343.

[00:51:38] And rounding out the blocks, third reading, final passage, uncontested counter block. House Bills 1347 and House Bill 1353. Shall the bills pass? Purple, close the rope.

[00:51:56] Ayes 96, noes 0. Ayes 96, noes 0, the bill's passed. Continuing with today's calendar, page 9, new category, house bills on third reading, regular. Final passage on the regular calendar for the 20-ish bills, beginning with House Bill 1095, which is now before you, which would, relates to high school students' completion of certain applications for student financial aid required, opt-out exemption.

[00:52:26] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 61, noes 35, abstentions 1.

[00:52:42] Eyes 61, noes 35, abstentions 1, the bill passes. House Bill 190, now before you, would direct the Office of the Attorney General to convene a work group to review best practices for financial institutions in preventing and responding to financial fraud or scams. Shall the bill pass?

[00:53:01] Clerk will close the bill. Ayes 95, noes 1. Ayes 95, noes 1, the bill passes. Mr. Speaker, Mr. Speaker. The delegate for more, no, Delegate Rasul.

[00:53:17] Mr. Speaker, having voted on the prevailing side by which we passed a block of bills. On third reading, uncontested, I would move that we reconsider those votes so that someone may cast their vote.

[00:53:34] The delegate from Roanoke City, Delegate Rousseau, moves that having voted on the prevailing side by which we passed the uncontested block on third read, that we should reconsider that vote so that a member may cast a vote. All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to.

[00:53:50] The clerk will reopen the roll on the third. There we go. That thing. The clerk will close the roll. Mr. Speaker, this time, 98 ayes, noes, zero.

[00:54:09] This time, 98, noes, zero. The bill's passed this time. Really, man. Continuing with House bills on third reading, regular, the third bill in this new category. Now before you is House Bill 300, which relates to expiration of cooperative agreements, period of oversight by State Health Commissioner, transfer of records.

[00:54:29] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes, 81, noes, 15. Ayes, 81, noes, 15.

[00:54:45] The bill passes. Over on page 10, we come to House Bill 429, relates to Electric Utilities, Integrated Resource Plan, State Corporation Commission, Commission on Electric Utility Regulation, Work Group Report. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:55:07] Ayes, 84, noes, 13. Ayes, 84, noes, 13. The bill passes. House Bill 476 relates to continuing care providers meeting requirements. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:55:30] Ayes, 83, noes, 14. Ayes, 83, noes, 14. The bill passes. House Bill 484 relates to health insurance, ethics in fairness, and carrier business practices, downcoded claims. Shall the bill pass?

[00:55:55] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 97, no's 1. Ayes 97, no's 1. The bill passes. House Bill 508 relates to small renewable energy projects, agrivoltaics, definition. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:56:19] Ayes 66, no's 30. Ayes 66, no's 30. The bill passes. House Bill 618 relates to health insurance reporting requirements. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:56:41] Ayes 92, no's 1. Ayes 92, no's 1. The bill passes. House Bill 625 relates to health insurance limit on cost-sharing payments for prescription drugs under certain plans. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:57:05] Ayes 63, no's 35. Ayes 63, no's 35. The bill passes. Over on page 12, if you're following along that way, we come to House Bill 676, legislation relating to health insurance claims, electronic attachments accepted. Shall the bill pass?

[00:57:27] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes. 98, noes 0. Ayes 98, noes 0. The bill passes. House Bill 770 relates to public utilities, water, and sewage companies discounted rates for low-income customers.

[00:57:43] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes. 64, noes 33. Ayes 64, noes 33.

[00:57:59] The bill passes. House Bill 841 is by for the day. Therefore, the next bill, third reading regular, is House Bill 892, related to electric utilities, integrated resource plans, state corporation commission to investigate electric load forecasts. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:58:23] Ayes, 63, no's 32. Ayes, 63, no's 32. The bill passes. House Bill 1166 relates to financial institutions, check cashers, expiration of registration. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:58:45] Ayes 91, noes 6. Ayes 91, noes 6. The bill passes. House Bill 1255 relates to net energy metering, standby charge, facility capacity. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:59:07] Ayes 86, noes 11. Ayes 86, noes 11. The bill passes. Turning to page 14, House Bill 1370 relates to Board of Behavioral Health and Developmental Services, Regulations, Service Providers, Emergency Medical Drills. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:59:32] Ayes 93, noes 5. Ayes 93, noes 5. The bill passes. House Bill 1448, creating the Petersburg Parking Authority Act. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:59:54] Ayes 88, noes 10. Ayes 88, noes 10. The bill passes. House Bill 898 directs the State Corporation Commission to determine maximum allowable fees for disconnection and reconnection charged by certain electric utilities, disconnections for nonpayment.

[01:00:11] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes, 84, no's 14. Ayes, 84, no's 14. The bill passes.

[01:00:28] House Bill 1062 relates to electric utilities, pilot program for electric energy conservation, generation, and storage. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row.

[01:00:48] Ayes, 76, no's 22. Ayes, 76, no's 22. The bill passes. And lastly, we come to House Bill 1225. In this category, legislation related to electric utilities, transportation, electrification, electric vehicle, fast charging stations. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes, 88, noes, 9. Ayes, 88, noes, 9. The bill passes.

[01:01:20] Continuing with today's calendar, new category, House bills on second reading, uncontested, approximately a dozen and a half bills in this category, top of page 16. New category, first bill, uncontested, second reading is House Bill 49. House Bill 49 seeks to amend and reenact sections code of Virginia relating to parimutuel wagering, historical horse racing, percentage retained for distribution.

[01:01:43] legislation report committee on general laws. Delegate from Lowen County, Delegate Reed. Yes, Mr. Speaker, I move the committee substitute. Shall substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 49 provides that revenue from the historical horse racing terminals now be also distributed to the Shenandoah County Agricultural Foundation and Great Meadow Foundation to support the promotion, education, maintenance, and safety of horse racing at such facilities. I hope it'll be the will of body to engross the bill and move it on to its third reading.

[01:02:16] Mr. Speaker, Members of the House, going on to the next bill is House Bill 54. House Bill 54 seeks to amend and reenact four sections, three sections of the code, four sections of the code of Virginia relating to the Department of Human Resource Management, State Government Internship Coordinator, Legislation originally reported to the Committee on General Law, Subsequently reported to the Committee on Appropriations with amendments.

[01:02:36] Delgate from Chesterfield, Douglas Dougherty. Mr. Speaker, I rise to see if we can go back to the first morning hour for a brief introduction. The delegate has the floor for a very, very, very brief introduction. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. It's my honor to introduce and welcome the students from Virginia State University Department of Social Work.

[01:02:55] Can you please stand? Mr. Speaker, housed within the College of Humanities and Social Sciences, this is the university's fastest growing program. The department prepares more than 400 bachelor and master's of social work students to serve communities across the Commonwealth through ethical practice, advocacy, and public service.

[01:03:14] The students are joining us today and are enrolled in the Social Welfare Policy and Services course and are visiting us at the General Assembly to gain first-hand insight into the policy-making process and impact of legislation on social work practice and community well-being. Please join me in giving the group a warm house welcome.

[01:03:43] The Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Sullivan. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. H.B. 54, I move the committee amendments. Shall the committee amendments be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Thank you Mr. Speaker, HB 54 will establish the position of a state government internship coordinator at DHRM to attract high quality interns to the service of the Commonwealth, the goal of developing those interns in a way that supports their ability to compete for positions in agencies of the Commonwealth.

[01:04:11] The bill also requires the department to establish and administer a system to provide professional development opportunities for state interns, intern supervisors and human resources staff. I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Next up in the uncontested second reading block is House Bill 88, House Bill 88 seeks to amend and reenact sections of the Code of Virginia relating to highway rights of way invasive species legislation originally reported committee on transportation with amendment nature substitute subsequent reported from the committee on appropriations also with amendment nature substitute.

[01:04:42] The delegate from Arbor Morrow, Delegate Laffer. Thank you Madam Speaker. I move the adoption of the transportation substitute but I request the house reject the motion. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no.

[01:04:58] No. The substitute is not agreed to. Delegate Lauffer. Madam Speaker, I move the adoption of the appropriations substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The substitute is agreed to. Delegate Lauffer.

[01:05:14] Thank you, Madam Speaker. HB 88 seeks to continue the work of eradicating invasive species that plague our roadways. The impact of all invasive flora and fauna costs Virginia more than $1 billion each year and over $120 billion nationally.

[01:05:30] This bill expands the number of invasive species plants prohibited from state highways and creates a plan and implementation strategy for control and removal. Madam Speaker, I move the bill be engrossed and pass to its third reading. Continuing with the block over on page 18, we come to House Bill 108, which seeks to amend the code of Virginia related to the Department of Veteran Services, Honor Guard Grant Program established.

[01:05:55] This is a Legislation Report Committee on General Laws, subsequent reported from the Committee on Appropriations. The delegate from Giles, Delegate Ballard. Thank you, Madam Speaker. Members of the House, HB 108 establishes the Honor Guard Grant Program to assist veteran service organizations in providing Honor Guard burial details at the funerals of veterans in Virginia.

[01:06:16] Hope it's the pleasure of the House to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. House Bill 140, now before your sixth amendment, reenact three sections that go to Virginia related to the Commission on Federally Recognized Tribes, Purpose Power, Sunset Extended. Legislation report, committee on rules. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Cresick.

[01:06:32] Thank you, Madam Speaker, members of the body. House Bill 140 is a unanimous recommendation by the Bipartisan Commission on Updating Virginia Law to reflect federal recognition of Virginia Tribes to extend the Commission Sunset, which was scheduled for this july 1 for an additional two years to july 1 2028 this was originally established back in 2022 and the tribal code commission as we call it has been tasked with consulting tribal leaders government agencies and constituents to identify and craft important bipartisan solutions this year we've got seven bills that came out of that commission unanimously i hope it's a will the body to engross this bill and pass it on to its third reading next up in

[01:07:11] the block house bill 169 seeks to amend the code of virginia relating to the virginia emergency Management Preparedness and Capabilities Grant Program and Fund Established Report. Legislation report committee on appropriations with the amendment nature of substitute. The delegate from Virginia Beach. Delegate Askew. Thank you, Madam Speaker. Madam Speaker, I move the committee substitute.

[01:07:28] Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. Sessitutes agree to. Delegate Askew. Thank you, Madam Speaker. Madam Speaker, HB169 responds to the looming FEMA layoff and federal funding cuts by preparing Virginia to take greater responsibility for its own emergency preparedness and resilience.

[01:07:45] directs the Secretary of Public Safety and Homeland Security to convene a stakeholder work group, including VDEM, DDP, and local governments. Taxi Group, we're recommending how to stabilize and strengthen emergency management funding, capabilities, and reduce dependence on uncertain federal dollars. Lastly, it recognizes a rising severe weather risk and pressure on insurance markets across Virginia.

[01:08:04] I hope it's a willing body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reader. House Bill 354, now before you cease to amend and reenact. Section 411. Before you now, seeks to amend the Code of Virginia related to the Commissioner of Highway, certain agreements with the U.S.

[01:08:40] Department of Transportation, National Environmental Policy Act. Legislation originally reported to the Committee on Transportation, then subsequent report by the Committee on Appropriations. The delegate from Loudon, Delegate Reed. Thank you, Madam Speaker. House Bill 411 authorizes the Commissioner of Highways to enter into agreements for a term of five years with the U.S. Department of Transportation to become the lead agency on National Environmental Policy Act projects. I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and move it on to its third reading. Next up in the uncontested second reading block is House Bill 500. This is Legislation authorized the Department of Conservation and Recreation to acquire certain property to establish a state park in Loudoun County.

[01:09:16] Legislation originally reported a committee on agriculture, Chesapeake, and Natural Resources with amended nature substitutes, subsequently reported by the committee on impressions with a different substitute. The delegate from Flock here, Delegate McAuliffe. Thank you, Madam Speaker. I move adoption of the Agriculture Committee substitute, but I request the House reject the motion.

[01:09:34] Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. No. The substitute is rejected. Delegate McCullough. Thank you, Madam Speaker. I now move adoption of the appropriations substitute and ask the body to accept the motion.

[01:09:50] Shall this appropriations substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The substitute is agreed to. Delegate McCullough. Thank you, Madam Speaker. HB 500 would very simply allow the Department of Conservation and Recreation to acquire approximately 1,200 acres of property on Oak Hill Farm, which is the home of former president and founding father, James Monroe, for the purpose of establishing and operating a state park. This is a once-in-generation opportunity to conserve a significant amount of property that will benefit not only those in Loudoun County, but across Virginia, where

[01:10:25] 30 percent of the state lives within an hour away from Oak Hill. So I hope it will be the bill of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Next up, House Bill 529 seeks to amend and reenact three sections of the Code of Virginia relating to suicide prevention program created despite suicide of veterans or military service members inquiry by the state register of vital records department of veterans services annual report legislation originally reported committee on health and human services with amendments and then subsequently reported by the committee on appropriations get from hampton delegate thwarton

[01:10:59] madam speaker i move the house to adopt the committee the committed to adopt the amendments Shall the amendments be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The amendments are agreed to. Delegate Thornton. House Bill 529 would codify veteran suicide prevention programs into law and allow the Department of Veterans Services to continue its incredible work to serve those who have served.

[01:11:27] Nearly 200 veterans have died to suicide in 2023. Every suicide is one suicide too many. Madam Speaker, I move that this bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading.

[01:11:43] Continuing with the block, we come to House Bill 680, which seeks to amend and reenact three sections of the Code of Virginia related to the Forensic Science Board, Scientific Advisory Committee, members, service after expiration of term, Legislation Report Committee on Public Safety, Madam Speaker, with an amendment.

[01:11:59] The delegate from Campbell, Delegate Sear. Thank you, Madam Speaker. I move the amendment. Shall the amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The amendments agreed to. Delegates here. Thank you, Madam Speaker. The good news is our Department of Forensic Science has a new headquarters in Hanover County.

[01:12:18] The bad news is our code says they have to meet in Richmond. This bill cleans that up, removes the conflict. And I move that we move this to the third reading. Continuing with the blocks, second reading, uncontested calendar, House Bill 772.

[01:12:37] Now before you is legislation to amend and reenact sexual code of Virginia relating to the federal workforce innovation and opportunity act adult and dislocated workers funds minimum allocation requirement eliminated this legislation was supported committee on appropriations with the amendment nature of substitute the delegate from hampton delegate thornton madam speaker i move the house adopt the appropriations committee substitute shall the substitute be agreed to all those in favor say i as opposed no substitutes agree to delegate Thornton. HB 772 would eliminate penalties and establish a waiver process for workforce boards

[01:13:16] that fail to spend 40% of the funds that are given to them by the federal government. This will allow the Commonwealth to redirect funds to other development programs authorized by the federal and state statute. Madam Speaker, I move that this bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Continuing with the block net bill before you next is House Bill 1114 which seeks to amend and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia relating to military leaves of absence for employees of the Commonwealth or political subdivisions law enforcement officers. Legislation reporting on public safety. The delegate from Henrico, Delegate Navar. Thank you Madam Speaker.

[01:13:55] Under current law, Virginia's law enforcement officers must use their own paid time off after 160 hours of federal military duty or training. House Bill 1114 raises that threshold to 388 hours, the same benefit already provided to our firefighters. This change ensures our officers can meet both their military and public safety responsibilities without facing financial strain.

[01:14:19] Madam Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed on to its third reading. Top of page 23, we come to House Bill 1299, which seeks to amend the Code of Virginia relating to rules of construction, use of the word shall. Legislation report committee on rules with amendments. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Delaney. Thank you, Madam Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the

committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. As opposed, no. The substitute, sorry, the substitute is agreed to. Delegate Delaney.

[01:14:49] Thank you, Madam Speaker. House Bill 1299 establishes that when the law uses the word shall it creates a mandatory duty to be followed the substitute in 1299 additionally directs that the Virginia Code Commission will review the code and evaluate what laws should be kept permissive and not directory along with the delayed reenactment clause to be re-established after the report from the Code Commission is received so this this bill will reaffirm the type of precision that the law requires preventing it from being misinterpreted and it is my hope that it will be the pleasure of the body to engross the bill and move it forward.

[01:15:29] Next up in the block is House Bill 1300. This is legislation to amend and reenact the Section of the Code of Virginia related to the purchase of handguns or other weapons of certain officers. Department of State Police, Legislative Reporting Committee on Public Safety. The delegate from Grayson, Delegate Cornett. Thank you, Madam Speaker.

[01:15:45] HB 1300 authorizes the Department of State Police with approval from the superintendent to allow the immediate survivor of a former law enforcement officer who served at least 10 years with the department and died while receiving long-term disability payments to purchase the officer's service weapon for $1.

[01:16:02] I asked that it be the pleasure of the body to engross the bill and pass it to the third reading. Turning to page 24, we come to House Bill 1322, which would designate the bridge on Roxbury Road, State Route 106, at the border of Charles City County and New Kent County and Charles City County, the Sheriff Javier J. Smith Memorial Bridge.

[01:16:22] This is the Legislation Report Committee on Rules. The Delegate from Richmond City, Delegate McQuinn. Thank you, Madam Speaker. Madam Speaker, Sheriff Smith worked for many years in the Chesterfield County and the Charles City area, and this was a request from that community that the bridge would be named after him, Sheriff Jiver J. Smith Memorial Bridge.

[01:16:42] And so I moved that House Bill 1322 be engrossed and passed on to his third reading. House Bill 1463, now before you cease to amend and reenact section code Virginia relating to zoning, non-conforming uses, manufactured homes, legislation reporting on county, cities, and towns. The delegate from Prince William, Delegate Thomas.

[01:16:59] Thank you, Madam Speaker. Madam Speaker, House Bill 1463 is a good property rights and affordable housing bill. It merely allows manufactured homes that have been subsequently deemed a non-conforming use to continue to be conforming so long as they are in continuous use. I hope it would be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass on to its third reading. And lastly, in this block, we come to House Bill 1477, legislation to amend and reenact portions of the Acts of Assembly of 1918, which provide a charter for the city of Norfolk relating to conformity with zoning ordinance.

[01:17:29] Legislation report committee on county, cities, and towns. The delegate from Virginia Beach. Delegate Askew. Thank you, Madam Speaker. Madam Speaker, HB 1477 gives Norfolk the same narrow authority Alexander has long used to address outdated grandfathered uses that harm neighborhoods for respecting property rights. It creates legislative paths to transition problem legacy uses towards state standards for safety and neighborhood quality.

[01:17:50] I hope it's willing to body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Shall the bills be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Ms. Speaker, members of the House, we come to a new category, House bills on second reading, regular, approximately 30 bills or so in this category. Page 25, if you're following along that way, we come first up to House Bill 1161, which seeks to amend and reenact portions of the Code of Virginia relating to the Government Data Collection and Dissemination Practices Act, Dissemination of Personal Information to Federal Government, Civil Penalties, the Legislature's Report Committee on General Laws.

[01:18:27] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Tran. Thank you so much, Mr. Speaker. I described and we debated House Bill 1161 earlier this month, and at that time we did not engross the bill and move it to its third reading, and I move that we do so today. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed its third reading?

[01:18:43] All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed its third reading. House Bill 524 is by for the day. Therefore, the next bill is House Bill 975. House Bill 975 seeks to amend and reenact three sections to go to Virginia relating to alcoholic beverage control, food-to-beverage ratio report.

[01:19:00] This legislation will report a committee on general laws with an amendment. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Bennett Parker. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee amendment. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. Committee amendment is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 975 creates a tiered structure to modernize Virginia's mixed beverage annual review or in-bar law, which has not seen a substantive update in more than 35 years.

[01:19:23] Today, a large number of consumers seek restaurants that specialize in craft cocktails or rare and limited edition spirits. For these restaurants, even with serving plenty of high quality food, meeting the current flat 45 percent food ratio becomes mathematically difficult, if not impossible. For example, a $5 pour of bourbon can have the same amount of alcohol as a $25 or $50 pour of bourbon, but a restaurant would have to sell five or ten times as much food to meet the ratio.

[01:19:45] The bill, which is supported by the Virginia Restaurant Lodging and Travel Association, modernizes our law to allow restaurants to operate in a way that reflects modern pricing and consumer preferences while maintaining the integrity of Virginia's mixed beverage licensing structure. I move the bill be engrossed and pass to its third reading. So the bill be engrossed?

[01:20:01] Mr. Speaker. The delegate from Roanoke City. Mr. Speaker, will the delegate yield for a question? Would the delegate yield for a question? I yield, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I would ask the delegate, does she know that the food on the other end of the hall is just terrible, this new senator-elect?

[01:20:21] Mr. Speaker, to the delegate, I would say that I will very much miss the food in the House and that I have paid for my entire session's worth of meals, and I believe it would be contrary to our affordability agenda to deny me access. Mr. Speaker, we thank the new senator-elect.

[01:20:51] Y'all do know when she goes down that she's still going to kill y'all bills. Y'all might want to retract that standing ovation. The delegate from Mr. Clerk, show the bill being grossed and passed the third reading.

[01:21:14] All those in favor say aye. Those opposed know the bill being grossed and passed the third reading. Page 26, House Bill 5 is by for the day. Therefore, continuing second reading regular, page 27 of the calendar. Bill before you now is House Bill 19. House Bill 19, 6th Amendment, Reenacted, 2 Sections of Dakota Virginia related to purchase, possession, or transportation of a firearm, salt and battery of a family or household member, or intimate partner penalties.

[01:21:41] Legislation originally reported to the Committee on Public Safety. So that's what would advise the Committee on Appropriation. Deb from Arlington, Deb McClaw. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, speaking of bills that the senator-elect would support, HB 19 would effectively close what is known as the dating partner loophole. Given the lethal combination of domestic violence and firearms, this bill would incorporate the federal definition of intimate partner into the existing law that currently prohibits a person who has been convicted of assault and battery against a family or household member from purchasing, possessing, or transporting a firearm.

[01:22:11] Disarming those who commit intimate partner violence, regardless of marital status, is a matter of public safety and public health that will serve to reduce overall homicide rates in the Commonwealth. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and pass on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor, say aye.

[01:22:27] All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Next up, House Bill 20, also by Delegate McClure. This legislation seeks to amend and reenact sections of the Code of Virginia, this time relating to minimum wage, farm laborers or farm employees, temporary foreign workers. Legislation originally reported the Committee on Labor and Commerce.

[01:22:43] House will be reported by the Committee on Appropriations with an amendment. Delegate from Arlington, Delegate McClure. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House adopt the committee substitute. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? Amendment, excuse me. Should the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee amendment is agreed to.

[01:22:59] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, HB 20 would remove the farm worker exemption and temporary foreign worker exemption from the Virginia Minimum Wage Act, and as amended, there would be a delayed enactment until January 1, 2027. Under our current Virginia law, farm workers on large farms are only covered by the federal minimum wage at $725, and farm workers on small farms are excluded from the federal minimum wage protection in addition to our state minimum wage.

[01:23:22] This bill addresses the outliers who could choose to pay their workers very low wages. Employers who pay inhumane wages get unfair competitive advantage over farmers who are paying fair wages for this incredibly hard work, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move out the bill being gross and pass on to his third reading.

[01:23:39] Delegate from Scott County, Delegate Kilgore. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speak to the bill. Delegate, that's the floor. Mr. Speaker, ladies and gentlemen of the House, what we fail to realize here in House Bill 20 is that some of the smaller farms, Some of the smaller farms in my region, they provide housing, they provide food allowances and other things, which now, if they start paying this minimum wage, they are not going to be able to do.

[01:24:04] And I think, ultimately, this is going to cost jobs. So thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. Next up, House Bill 35.

[01:24:20] This is House Bill 35, seeks to amend and reenact section of the Code of Virginia related to restorative housing and isolated confinement restrictions on use. Legislation will report the Committee on Public Safety, subject to be reported by the Committee on Appropriation, with an amendment. Doug from Fredericksburg, Doug and Cole. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the Committee Amendment. Shall the Committee Amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The Committee Amendment is agreed to.

[01:24:41] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 35, they say third time's a charm. This body has passed solitary confinement restrictions for two years in a row, Mr. Speaker. And this year, we hope to have a chance to pass it for a third and final time. This bill will restrict solitary confinement to 15 days total in a 60-day period.

[01:24:58] The science of isolation is not a mystery to us. Prolonged isolation is a danger to the mind and the body. And at times, Mr. Speaker, are a-changing. Our Commonwealth is more ready than ever to bring a humane compassion to rehabilitation inside of our prisons. I hope it will be the pleasure of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading.

[01:25:14] Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 41 is legislation to amend and reenact to Section of the Code of Virginia relating to elections. Administration procedures for removal of electoral board members and general registrars.

[01:25:29] Legislation reporting on privileges and elections. The delegate for Fairfax, delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 41 provides two new methods for removing electoral board members and general registrars who are neglecting their basic ministerial duties. It allows for the state electoral board by a two-thirds vote after a public hearing to remove a registrar or electoral board member.

[01:25:49] It allows local electoral boards by unanimous vote after a public hearing to remove registrars through the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. Mr. Speaker. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. House, continuing with the calendar, page 30, House Bill 212 is legislation to amend and reenact Section Dakota Virginia related to elections, election offenses, intimidation and threats towards election officers, penalty legislation reported from the Committee on Privileges and Elections.

[01:26:20] Delegate from Chesterfield, Delegate Gardner. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, bipartisan groups of election officials, administrators, and poll workers administer our elections as an essential part of our democracy. In 2025, a survey stated that one in three local officials reported threats, harassments, or abuse because of their job, and seasoned professionals have been driven out of the election administration, leading to an unsustainable turnover.

[01:26:50] House Bill 2012 updates the criminal code to better protect election workers so that they can do their part to secure our elections by removing the word willfully component from the crime of hindering or preventing election officials and their employees from administering elections.

[01:27:07] This legislation would require the prosecution to prove only that the accused intentionally hindered election administration. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor say aye.

[01:27:23] All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed to its third reading. House Bill 234 is legislation that seeks to amend the Code of Virginia relating to elections, general provisions, electoral board members to wear identification, civil penalty. Legislation reported from the Committee on Privileges and Elections.

[01:27:39] Delegate from Dinwiddie, Delegate Pope Adams. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. H.B. 234 requires standardized identification badges for acting electoral board members on election day so voters and observers can clearly see who is exercising official authority.

[01:27:56] This bill does not change election procedures, expand authority, or burden localities. Mr. Speaker, I hope it is the will of the body to engross this bill and pass it to its third reading. Doug from Scott County, Delegate K. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speak to the bill. Doug, you have the floor. Mr. Speaker, ladies and gentlemen of the House, you know, it's really hard to get electoral board members and members to work the polls around the Commonwealth.

[01:28:20] And, you know, for a state that doesn't even require voter ID, we're going to require individuals who work the polls to have their ID, but they don't even know who they're going to be. We just, up above, we just, House Bill 212, we just said if you threaten an election official, then it's a crime.

[01:28:39] But we won't even know who they are because we don't know who the voters are because there's no voter ID in Virginia. So I think we just got this all backwards. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no.

[01:28:56] The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 549 is legislation that seeks to amend and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia relating to conservation and replacement of trees during development process. Legislation will work related to county, cities, and towns with amendment nature substitute. That's from Arlington, delegate hope.

[01:29:11] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I approve the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 549 would provide localities with authority to protect and restore their tree stock when commercial and residential development occurs.

[01:29:28] House Bill 549 is 100% permissive to the localities. It will be a pleasure of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third read. Shall the bill be engrossed? Mr. Speaker. I'm sorry. Is that from Fauquier, Delegate Weber? Apologize, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, will the delegate yield for a question? Will the delegate yield? I will yield.

[01:29:44] Delegate yield. Mr. Speaker, I would ask the gentleman that if localities that adopt these type of regulations, could that increase the cost of housing? Mr. Speaker, I would tell the delegate that the people want to have trees, mature trees.

[01:30:05] They provide a lot of benefits for the environment and, of course, for their curb appeal for their home. So I think they'll make things more desirable to the public to have more trees. And who doesn't love a tree, Mr. Speaker? I'd thank the delegate.

[01:30:24] Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. Next up on page 31, we come to House Bill 639, which seeks to amend and reenact the Act of the Code of Virginia relating to elections, administration, acceptance of certain gifts, and funding approval required.

[01:30:41] Legislation report committee on privileges and elections. That's for Fairfax, Delegate Creasy. Thank you, Mr. Speaker, members of the body. House Bill 639 creates a narrow exception to current code to allow localities to accept less than $1,000 in grant funding for election administration with prior approval from the governing body or the State Board of Elections.

[01:31:00] Under current law, local election officials are prohibited from accepting any private or philanthropic funding for election administration. You know the work of our local registrars has grown significantly more complex, but despite these growing demands, election administration remains chronically underfunded.

[01:31:17] The goal is simple, Mr. Speaker. We want to keep small, routine support, practical, and make sure anything meaningful is reviewed in public. I hope it's the will of the body to engross this bill and pass it on to its third reading. Delegate from Sussex, Delegate Waxman. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I have a question for the patron.

[01:31:33] Will the delegate yield for a question? I yield. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The question that I have is a few years ago we restricted that ability for outside entities to help fund our electoral process with the zero fee. I understand that it is limited to $1,000 now, but I ask, what would stop an organization that wanted to impact our election process by having multiple members make multiple donations of $1,000?

[01:32:03] Mr. Speaker, I would answer the delegate that, firstly, you might wonder why $1,000. The idea there is that the threshold is high enough to cover these kind of routine operational things, but low enough that anything with real financial weight triggers oversight.

[01:32:21] If there was going to be, let's say you had a situation, which I don't think is very realistic, but it's possible, if there's any kind of evasion, it would be treated just as we do with other kinds of things like procurement, other areas of the law, like procurement, campaign, finance, ethics, as one transaction.

[01:32:48] So it would be treated the same way as evasion. And so I don't think that would be a problem in this case. Mr. Speaker, speaking to the bill. Doug, you have the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Virginia has long traditions here, and I think the electoral process is something that is vital and key with the integrity of what we do here in the state.

[01:33:06] And I would not want any outside group to influence this. Another thing that is stricken from this language is the word services. So those entities that may in the past, like in the 2020 election, funded money in for drop boxes in certain key districts.

[01:33:21] Instead of giving the money to do that the way that this language is, it would allow them as a service to install those drop boxes as a service for those electoral borders and registrars. And I just feel like in Virginia, Virginia needs to be in charge of our elections and not outside entities.

[01:33:38] Thank you, sir. Mr. Speaker. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Next up, House

Bill 650. It's legislation to amend and reenact sections of the Code of Virginia relating to certain civil arrests prohibited in courthouses.

[01:33:55] Penalty. Legislation reported including on public safety with an amendment nature substitute. Delegate from Albemarle, Delegate Carlson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 650 is a bill about protecting our public safety.

[01:34:12] It sets out clear parameters for how civil and administrative arrests should occur in our courthouses, hospitals, schools, and sensitive voting locations. The bill is narrowly tailored for each location, but in general requires that any enforcement activity in those areas be conducted transparently and with respect to due process, i.e. requiring a judicial warrant, subpoena, or notification before entering into private or protected areas.

[01:34:36] Arrests have been taking place on the steps and in the halls of our courthouses, confusing attorneys, court participants, and even our court personnel who are tasked with maintaining security. It is creating a chilling effect on our judicial system, making it so victims, witnesses, and even those wishing to comply, just comply with our laws, afraid to come forward, and that's a problem.

[01:34:59] This bill requires officers to identify themselves and provide a judicial warrant codifying Virginia's common law principle around courthouse arrests. Access to courts is a fundamental right upon which all other rights depend and the same can be said about access to our schools for education, access to our hospitals for care, and access to the very core of our democracy: voting and fair elections free of federal interference. There's a lot of F's but I got through it. All of these are sacred places and activities that this bill wishes to protect by establishing clear due process protection because protecting the

[01:35:36] integrity and safety of those spaces essentially protects us all. So I hope it is the will of this body to engross the bill and pass it to its third reading. Delegate from Scott County, Delegate Kilgore. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speak to the bill. Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, ladies and gentlemen of the House, this is a clear violation of the Supremacy Clause. You know, and ladies and gentlemen, when And the delegate from Albemarle stated that we're trying to make it safer for our communities.

[01:36:05] What you're doing in courthouses, in hospitals, those are gun-free zones. When ICE or some other federal agency goes in and makes their arrest there, it takes them out of the community. So you're doing exactly the opposite of what you want to do here.

[01:36:22] Because they are going to, and the further thing about it is, where are people with charges that we want to remove from the country going to be? They're going to be in court. They're going to be there where they can easily be taken into custody for their violations of United States law.

[01:36:40] So, ladies and gentlemen, by voting for this, you're making us less safe here in the Commonwealth. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. So the bill being grossed and passed the third reading. All those in favor, say aye.

[01:36:56] All those opposed, no. The bill's being grossed and passed the third reading. Over on page 32, we come to House Bill 702, which is legislation to amend and reenact section of the Code of Virginia relating to the Virginia Firearm Give Back Program and Fund established. Legislation originally reported

committee on public safety with nature substitute, then subsequent reported by the committee on appropriations.

[01:37:14] Doug from Fredericksburg, Delegate Cole. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 702 is a Section 1 bill that creates a more standardized system of voluntary gun give-back programs for each local law enforcement agency.

[01:37:34] It gives guidance to local LEAs on which firearms to hold on to and for how long. It gives guidance on handling firearms that may be evidence in a crime. It gives guidance on how to either donate historically significant and antique firearms to museums or to auction them through a federally licensed firearms dealer.

[01:37:49] and it also permits localities to recoup funds through auctions or historically significant and antique firearms. This wonderful bill was brought to us from the city of Fredericksburg who's been doing a similar program since 2014 and so I hope it'll be the privilege of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Doug from Patrick County, Doug Williams. Yes Mr. Speaker I was wondering if the patron would yield for a question. Would the patron yield for a question?

[01:38:11] Mr. Speaker I yield. If the patron would please answer my question would be we just passed HB 217 which was the grandfathered assault rifle ban. And in it, it had pretty narrow exceptions. You couldn't sell it.

[01:38:28] You couldn't transfer it. And it did not have any carve-out for law enforcement agencies. So I was wondering how we would be able to utilize the give-back program if both bills passed at the same time. Mr. Speaker, I respond to the gentleman that the bill clearly states that each local department will have the ability to set the standard and set up their own policies.

[01:38:47] And so by passing this bill, people will be protected in order to do so. Mr. Speaker, speaking to the bill, that won't change the fact that HB 217 says you can't transfer any firearms privately. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. So the bill bill goes and pass the third reading.

[01:39:02] All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Bill's engrossed and pass the third. Next up, House Bill 774 seeks to amend and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia related to elections, absentee and provisional ballots, cure process, legislation for privileges and elections with an amendment, nature or substitute.

[01:39:18] Delegate from Hampton, Delegate Thornton. Mr. Speaker, I move the House to adopt the substitution. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substituted agreed to. Thank you. House Bill 774 would require the electoral board to promptly inform voters via email or telephone that their provisional ballot forms contain errors and give them until Monday noon after the election to correct those errors.

[01:39:50] This legislation brings about fairness and equality. It also helps to confirm eligibility. Mr. Speaker, I move that this bill be engrossed and passed on to its third reading. From Patrick County, Delegate Williams. Mr. Speaker, speaking to the bill.

[01:40:05] Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, I just want to let everybody know that the biggest concern I have about this bill is only the fact that, and I've seen this in Wisconsin and other places, is when you have

smaller clerk's office or registrar's office and they have more limited staff, They're not able to put the time and energy into trying to cure ballots, which this would sort of give them a requirement to do, a mandate to do.

[01:40:35] And so it really sets up a disparity between bigger offices that might have the resources to reach out, find people, and cure ballots versus smaller offices that don't have that resources, and it sets up that two-tier disparity system.

[01:40:51] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall the bill be engrossing past the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossing past the third reading. Top of page 33. Bill before you next, House Bill 835. Seeks to amend and reenact multiple sections of Dakota, Virginia, all relating to elections, candidates, and elected officials, address, confidentiality.

[01:41:09] Legislation will report a committee on privileges and elections. Delegate McClure. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, HB 835 would enhance the safety and privacy of elected officials and candidates across the Commonwealth. As you know, in recent years, political violence, harassment, and targeted threats against public officials in campaigns have increased nationwide, including here in the Commonwealth.

[01:41:29] HB 835 would strike a balance between transparency and safety, and it retains public access to relevant election information, still allows DOE to verify that the candidate is within a certain district, and limits unnecessary exposure to precise personal data that could jeopardize personal security.

[01:41:47] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed on to its third reading. Should a bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed no. Bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 909 before you now seeks to amend and reenact multiple sections of the Code of Virginia relating to elections, administration, certain activities or conduct prohibited at polling places applicable to locations for absentee voting in person, possession of firearm within 100 feet of location used for certain voting related and election related activities, penalty. Legislation report committee on privileges election with amendment nature substitute. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Shen.

[01:42:18] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move the adoption of the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 909 extends the prohibition of a firearm from 40 feet of a polling place to 100 feet.

[01:42:35] I would move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. The delegate from Scott County, Delegate Kilgore. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speak to the bill. Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, ladies and gentlemen of the House, this is a law that will have unintended consequences, I think. or maybe it's intended. I'm not sure. But we have a lot of hunters in rural Virginia.

[01:42:53] And on election day, when I'm working the polls, I will stand there and a lot of these hunters will come in early in the morning. They'll have their gun with them or late in the evening after it gets dark. So what we're doing, Mr. Speaker is saying, and all these schools out here where we vote in rural Virginia, you know, you pull right up to the polling place, you park in the parking lot, and you're definitely within 100 feet. So this is a law of unintended consequences that are going to make a lot of law-abiding citizens all

of a sudden criminals. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third read.

[01:43:33] Continuing with today's counter, we come to House Bill 916. This is legislation amendment to reenact two sections of Dakota, Virginia, relating to concealed handgun permit, demonstrated competence. Legislation reported committee on public safety. That's from Arlington, Deputy Lopez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Concealed carry License applications allow for three types of approved courses for an applicant to demonstrate proof of competence. Either one, a training course that teaches responsible use, state laws, and proper storage. Two, a training course that is administered by the U.S. Concealed Carry Association. Or three, by the National Rifle Association. The issue is the code will far outlast the life of any organization or program, putting these requirements at risk

[01:44:09] if these groups ever close, dramatically change, or drastically adjust their training courses. This bill, Mr. Speaker, would provide a simple fix for this issue. Removing reference to training is specifically administered by the NRA and USCCA, and instead solely approving any course that teaches, one, efficient, effective, and responsible use of concealed handgun for self-defense outside the home, two, all state laws regarding firearms, and three, proper weapons storage techniques. The bill does not weaken training requirements or exclude the USCCA or the NRA.

[01:44:38] It simply guarantees all course providers follow the same standards and that Virginians are not dependent on any specific organization. Mr. Speaker, I move that we engross the bill and pass it on to Which third reading? Should the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading.

[01:44:54] Over on page 34, we come to House Bill 932. Legislation to amend Title 30 of the Code of Virginia and repeal portions thereof. It all relates to the General Assembly and members thereof, the legislative branch of government, and legislative commissions, councils, committees, and other legislative entities.

[01:45:13] Legislative report committing on rules with amendments. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, I move the committee amendments. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Committee amendment is agreed to. Mr. Speaker, this is the revision of Title 30 of the Code of Virginia.

[01:45:29] If you'll bear with me, I'll read this report to you here. House document number five. In accordance with its authority, granted, no. So this is the recodification of Title 30. Title 30 was first enacted. It hasn't been revised since it was first enacted in 1950 when we codified the entire Code of Virginia in 1950.

[01:45:47] So it hasn't been looked at since then. In the meantime, we've had a lot of changes to it, and they've been added in different places, and there's some duplication, some obsolete provisions. So this is just a regular part of the Code Commission's work to go through and find these code sections that haven't been looked at in a while, reorganize them, delete the obsolete and duplicative provisions, and clean everything up.

[01:46:05] And that's what's happened with this bill. I hope it would be the pleasure of the body to engross the bill and pass it to its third reading. So the bill, the delegate from Falk here, Delegate Webb. Yes, Mr.

Speaker, will the gentleman yield for a question? Will the delegate yield for a question? I yield. Yes, Mr. Speaker.

[01:46:21] Mr. Speaker, I would ask him, what was the reasoning behind the amendment for, I guess, it's subsection D after line 39? Mr. Speaker, I would answer the delegate that the amendment, which is printed on the calendar on page 34, it codifies the longtime custom and practice of the House of Delegates to consider a special session that's not formally adjourned to expire upon the swearing-in of a new General Assembly after a general election of the House of Delegates.

[01:46:59] So we had a special session that we convened in 2024. It was never adjourned, recessed upon the call of the Speaker and went on. The members of that special session, their terms all expired back on January 14th, January 13th, I guess, at 11.59 p.m.

[01:47:19] And so when we swore in the new General Assembly at noon on the 14th, that special session went away. This just codifies that because that's the way we've always done it. But I think the question came up, where is it written down? The answer now will be it's in Title 30 in this section of the code.

[01:47:37] Will the gentleman yield for one more question? Will the gentleman yield for one more question? I will yield for as many more questions as the delegate has. No, you won't. The delegate will yield for one more question. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I would ask the gentleman so he can confirm that we are no longer in the 2024 special session and time is no longer continuing.

[01:48:00] Mr. Speaker, I would answer the delegate that the language in the bill codifies the long-time custom and practice of the House of Delegates. I thank the gentleman. Thank you. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye.

[01:48:16] All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Next up, we come to House Bill 964, legislation to amend and reenact multiple sections of the Code of Virginia relating to voter registration, restoration of political rights upon release from incarceration, certain applications.

[01:48:34] Legislation report committee on privileges in election with an amendment. Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee amendment. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee amendment is agreed to. Thank you. House Bill 964 is the enabling legislation for House Joint Resolution 2, the proposed constitutional amendment that would affirm a right to vote and automatically restore the voting rights of those convicted of a felony upon their physical release. It defines incarceration and release from incarceration for the purpose of restoring their political rights. It also removes the code that references the governor's authority in this process since that would change under the

[01:49:14] proposed amendment it also provides for the eligibility to register to vote upon the restoration of said rights sets out the mechanisms for information sharing from State Police Department of Corrections and State Board of Local and Regional Jails with the Department of Elections related to release of incarcerated persons and the committee amendment makes clear that all of this bill should only be enacted should the majority of voters say yes to the proposed constitutional amendment for voting rights in the November election Mr. Speaker I hope it is the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to his third reading. The delegate from Buckingham, Doug Garrett. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:49:47] Would the patron yield for a question? Would the patron yield for a question? Yes, I yield. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Hypothetically, presuming that the majority of voters do say yes, would this allow

the restoration of voting rights for a person who was ordered by the court to pay damages to an individual or the estate of an individual who was deceased for physical harm or damage done to that person's body that's permanent and lasts the rest of their life or to the property of that person or their family? Mr. Speaker, I would answer the delegate that the two definitions that are clearly and plainly defined in this bill, including

[01:50:22] release from incarceration, are delineated very clearly, and so that is upon physical release from incarceration to go along with the language of the proposed constitutional amendment. Mr. Speaker, would the patron yield for a clarification, please?

[01:50:38] Would the patron yield? I yield. Yes or no, a person who had harmed someone and crippled them for life who was ordered to pay damages could, under your bill, receive their voting rights back before they'd ever paid restitution or damages? Mr. Speaker, I would answer the delegate that, contrary to his belief, he can't make me say one thing or another.

[01:50:58] I said what I said. I just want you to say the truth. The truth. Nope. I'm sorry, Mr. Speaker. I apologize. Delegate Price. Upon physical release of incarceration. Should the bill be engrossed and passed the third read? All those in favor say aye.

[01:51:13] Those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third read. over on page 36 we come to house bill 965 this is legislation amend reenact section code of virginia related to the presidential electors and the agreement among the states to elect the president by national popular popular vote compact legislation work building on privileges of elections with amendments from newport news delegate price yes mr speaker i move the committee amendments committee member be agreed to all those in favor say aye all those opposed no the committee amendment is agreed to thank you mr speaker house bill 965 would add Virginia to the National Popular Vote Interstate Compact

[01:51:51] to re-enfranchise Virginia voters, such as the candidate who receives the most votes in all 50 states and D.C. wins the presidency based on one person, one vote. With this, Virginia would become the 18th state to join the compact on the way to 270 electoral votes needed to enact the compact.

[01:52:10] Mr. Speaker, the issues with the current system stem from the state-level winner-take-all laws that award all of the states' look to oral college votes to a candidate who receives the most popular votes inside that state. Because of this, five people have become president of our nation without winning the most votes.

[01:52:27] This means that the value of each vote is not equal across the country in presidential elections. This is also why presidential campaigns mostly only focus on battleground states. In 2024, that was just seven states, Mr. Speaker, that received an overwhelming focus of the presidential campaigns.

[01:52:43] This also means that the other 43 states and 80% of voters were on the sidelines, including Virginia voters. With all of the people, assets, and resources this great commonwealth has that the rest of the nation also depends on, Virginia voters do not deserve to be sidelined.

[01:52:59] Further, Mr. Speaker, voter participation is higher in closely divided battleground states because people know that their votes there matter. Let's help Virginians know and feel that their votes matter in presidential elections by joining the National Popular Vote Interstate Compact and engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading.

[01:53:17] The delegate from Scott County, Delegate Kilgore. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speak to the bill. Delegate, ask the floor. Mr. Speaker, ladies and gentlemen of the House, you know, this year, if we followed this rule, President Trump would have got all the votes from Virginia instead of the votes going to Kamala Harris.

[01:53:43] That's what would have happened under this rule. But what's going to happen, ladies and gentlemen, is that as we move forward, if this move forwards, California, New York, those big states would have such a bigger role in the election of a president. That's what's going to happen. Or, or on the flip side, if you look at Texas and Florida, the way they're going, you may, it may be even worse for your side of the aisle as we move forward. So this is a very dangerous move, I believe,

[01:54:21] ladies and gentlemen in the House. Our founding fathers, I think, did this one right. I know they did it right when they created the Electoral College because they were talking about the big states, the big states ruling the whole nation, the little states didn't have, the states with smaller populations didn't have such a say, and they set up this electoral college system.

[01:54:47] Ladies and gentlemen, this is something that can go both ways, and I do not think we need to change this and join this national popular vote compact. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor, say aye.

[01:55:06] All those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. Next up, we come to House Bill 967. This is legislation to amend and reenact, Section Code of Virginia, again, relating to elections, this time regarding the Voting Rights Act of Virginia. This is the Legislature Report Committee on Privileges and Elections.

[01:55:22] Zella from Newport News, Delegate Price. Mr. Speaker, thank you. House Bill 967 contains updates to the Voting Rights Act of Virginia. As you'll remember, in 2021, we were the first state in the South to enact our own state-level Voting Rights Act. Since then, we have been working with local, state, and national agencies and organizations to assess our ability to meet the needs of the moment for undergirding our democracy. In that vein, Mr. Speaker, House Bill 967 does a few things. One, it reorganizes some code sections. It also strengthens voter intimidation pieces. It delineates the factors

[01:56:00] to be considered in determining violations against protected classes. It lowers the threshold for minority language accessibility to allow for more people to get the access they need. It allows organizations to institute a cause of action in circuit court should there be a violation in addition to the affected voter or the AG or to challenge a proposed change to a covered practice should it negatively impact a protected class.

[01:56:23] And lastly, it also spells out the applicable provisions of the Federal Voting Rights Act instead of just referencing them. These changes will make the Voting Rights Act of Virginia even stronger, and I hope it will be the pleasure of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading?

[01:56:38] All those in favor say aye. Others opposed, no. The bill is engrossing past the third rate. House Bill 1040 now before you seek to amend and reenact two sections of Virginia relating to the Virginia Commonwealth University Health System Authority. Board of Directors, Chief Executive Officer. Legislation report originally from the Committee on Education, subsequently by the Committee on Appropriations.

[01:56:56] Doug from Richmond City, Doug Gickar. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 1040 simply implements several JLARC recommendations to improve the Virginia Commonwealth University, VCU, health authorities governance structure. This bill is the same as HB 2161, which passed the House and Senate unanimously last year, but was unfortunately vetoed by the governor because it reduced the number of executive branch appointments. I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and move it on to its third reading.

[01:57:29] Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 1096 is legislation to amend and reenact. Section of the Code of Virginia You're laying into a substantial risk order reporting system established. This legislation will report a committee on public safety with an amendment and then subsequently by the committee on appropriations.

[01:57:47] They're from Long County. Delegate Singh. Mr. Speaker, I move the committee amendment. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee amendment is agreed to. Mr. Speaker, current law has a substantial risk order registry maintained by the state police. That information is shared with a variety of entities.

[01:58:03] This bill would make that information public. The data is already being collected, and current law requires the police to remove names and personal information from being released. Mr. Speaker, I ask that the bill be engrossed and passed through its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed through its third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no.

[01:58:19] The bill's engrossed and passed through its third reading. Over on page 38, we come to House Bill 1212. This is legislation to amend the Code of Virginia relating to Small Lot Residential Zoning District. Legislation report committee on county, cities, and towns with an amendment of nature substitute. Delegate from Prince William, Delegate Sewell. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:58:34] Mr. Speaker, I move that the House adopt the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. the committee substitute has agreed to. Mr. Speaker, home ownership is increasingly out of reach for Virginians and land costs are one of the key drivers pushing new home prices higher.

[01:58:50] By allowing smaller lots, we can reduce development costs by using land and infrastructure more efficiently. This approach allows for a modest increase in the number of homes while remaining consistent with development patterns already found in many established Virginia neighborhoods. The result is greater opportunity for first-time homebuyers, downsizing seniors who want to remain in their communities and working families without relying on public subsidy.

[01:59:13] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and pass this third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. Next up, House Bill 1234. This legislation seeks to amend the Code of Virginia relating to land development, solar canopies, and surface parking areas.

[01:59:30] Legislation, again, reported committing on county, cities, and towns with the amendment of nature substitute. Delegate from Norfolk, Delegate Glass. Which one? 1212, my bad. 1234, Delegate Solar. Coming up wrong. Oh, I'm sorry. Delegate for Prince William, Dr. Sewell.

[01:59:48] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House adopt the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. House Bill 1234 gives localities a simple practical tool to make better use of space before, I'm sorry, to make better use of space we're already paving.

[02:00:10] Across Virginia, we build larger parking lots that sit in the sun all day, generating heat, but no additional value. This legislation allows localities, if they choose, to require solar canopies over new or expanded non-residential parking lots with 100 or more spaces.

[02:00:27] I want to be clear, this is not a statewide mandate. No locality is required to adopt this. It simply gives communities the opportunity to decide for themselves, based upon their own climate, energy, and land use goals, Whether solar parking canopies make sense. The benefits are straightforward. Lower costs, more in-state energy generation, shaded parking, and new clean energy jobs.

[02:00:48] This is smart, local, and practical energy policy. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and pass its third reading. Doug from Patrick County. Doug Williams. Yes, Mr. Speaker, if the patron would yield for a question. I yield. On lines 18, 19, and 20, it says on the B provision, it just says any locality may include in its ordinance.

[02:01:09] But then it says that an applicant shall install a solar canopy. Is this making somebody install a solar canopy if they apply? Doug, for Prince William.

[02:01:25] Mr. Speaker, I would respond, as I noted, that this is permissive language, which allows for a locality to adopt this language and to provide the opportunity for a locality to make a decision on what is best for them and their energy needs. Just speaking to the bill, Mr. Doug, can you ask the floor?

[02:01:41] I'm not trying to hurt her bill or anything. I just think it just sort of seems like if someone is applying, not the locality, because the locality would set up the ordinance, but then it seems to say like an applicant that is applying under the ordinance would, would shall install a solar canopy.

[02:02:00] So I just wanted to mention that, and I might have it wrong. That sounds likely. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading.

[02:02:15] House Bill 1262 now before you seeks to amend the Code of Virginia Lane of the Consumer Protection Act Advertisement for Immigration Assistance Services Civil Penalties. Legislation reporting committee on public safety with amendment nature substitute. Now the delegate from Norfolk, Delegate Glass.

[02:02:31] Gratitude, Mr. Speaker. I move the House adopt the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Gratitude, Mr. Speaker. So this bill expands on work done by Delegate Lopez up against notarios.

[02:02:47] They are people who fraudulently misrepresent themselves as qualified legal professionals to exploit immigrants, often leading to deportation, financial loss, and damaged legal costs. They exploit this linguistic similarities between the U.S. Notary Republic and the Latin American Notario Republico, which is a trained attorney.

[02:03:13] So this strengthens the protections for immigration service fraud by preventing them from misleading the public on their legal authority. It requires non-attorneys who advertise immigration

assistance services to clearly disclose that they are not licensed attorneys or accredited representatives.

[02:03:32] And it imposes a significant increase to the civil penalty for violations of unauthorized law practice. Mr. Speaker, I move the bill be engrossed and passed on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no.

[02:03:49] The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 1316. Now, before you, it seeks to amend the Code of Virginia, amend and reenact portion of the Code of Virginia relating to removal of clutter, agricultural use exemption, Planning District 19. Legislation reports many on county, cities, and towns. Delegate from Dinwiddie, Delegate Pope Adams.

[02:04:04] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 1316 makes a narrow but important clarification to Virginia's clutter statute as it applies to Planning District 19. The bill clarifies that only in Planning District 19, clutter ordinances do not apply to land zoned for agricultural use unless the parcel is one acre or less and used for residential purposes.

[02:04:27] Mr. Speaker, I hope it is the will of the body to engross this bill and pass it on to its third reading. Should the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 1392 seeks to amend and reenact sections of the Code of Virginia relating to the powers and duties for operation of local and regional correctional facilities and courthouse security.

[02:04:46] Attorney's access to courthouses and communication and visitation with incarcerated clients. Penalty legislation reporting from the Committee on Public Safety with amendments. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Keyes-Gumar. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speaking to the bill. Delegate has the floor.

[02:05:01] Mr. Speaker, House Bill 1392 provides uniformity in the operations of courthouses and local correctional facility operations. It adds four amendments to set appropriate standards for the use of attorney's bar cards to create uniform exemptions for bypassing courthouses security.

[02:05:21] It establishes standards for confidential access and communication between attorneys. Are there amendments? I move the amendments. Shall the committee members be agreed to? I hate to, you were making a great video. Shall the committee members be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye.

[02:05:40] Those opposed, no. The committee members are agreed to. Now back to the video. Now back to the video, Mr. Speaker. As I, as some of you may not have heard, House Bill 1392 provides uniformity in the operations of courthouses and local correctional facilities.

[02:05:58] It adds four specific items to make sure that we have access to justice for each and every one involved. It sets appropriate standards for the use of an attorney's bar cards. It creates uniform exemptions for bypassing courthouse security.

[02:06:17] It establishes standards for confidential access and communication between attorneys and their clients. and it establishes provisions for how you can have telephonic and electronic communication. I hope that it is the will of this body who supports justice for all that we engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading.

[02:06:39] Thank you. Cut. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed no, the bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Over on page 40, we come to House Bill 1441. It is legislation to amend and

reenact sections of the Code of Virginia relating to law enforcement officers enforcement of federal immigration law restrictions.

[02:07:03] Legislation report committee on public safety with an amendment nature of substitute. Delegate from Orleans and Delegate Lopez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. This bill is about keeping Virginians safe and improving trust between local and state law enforcement and the communities they serve.

[02:07:22] The bill would enable local and state law enforcement to stay focused on their core mission, preventing crime, responding to emergencies, and keeping communities safe. Also, it clarifies roles and responsibilities and supports stronger cooperation between law enforcement and the communities they serve, helping build trust and improve public safety outcomes.

[02:07:39] The bill, Mr. Speaker, focuses Virginia law enforcement on their core duties, to investigate and stop criminal conduct in our communities, to uphold the rule of law, and to maintain public trust. Mr. Speaker, I move we engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Should the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading?

[02:07:56] All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 1476 now before you seeks to amend and reenact sections of the Code of Virginia relating to a law enforcement civilian oversight bodies. Closed meetings, disclosure of certain law enforcement records. Legislation report, committee on public safety with an amendment nature substitute.

[02:08:16] Delegate for Richmond City, Delegate Smith. Mr. Speaker, I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to all those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The committee's substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, HB 1476 is a public safety bill which allows police auditors and review boards to access sensitive case files while protecting victims and witness privacy during investigation into misconduct.

[02:08:43] It is. I move that we engross the bill and pass it to its third reading. Should the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 1482, different bill, same patron.

[02:09:02] This legislation seeks to amend the Code of Virginia relating to law enforcement officers' restrictions on wearing facial coverings, required identification, civil liability, penalty. Legislation, again, reported committee on public safety, this time with line amendments. Delegate from Richmond City, Delegate Schmidt.

[02:09:18] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 1482 is also a public safety bill which outlines appropriate standards regarding police identification while interacting with the public in carrying out their official duties, which keep our communities safe. Oh, sorry.

[02:09:34] Oh, I was doing so good. I'd like to move the committee amendments. Yeah, thank you. We've got friends. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The committee amendment is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. As I was saying, H-Bill 1482 also lays out exceptions to account for undercover and emergency operations.

[02:09:55] I'd like to thank fellow delegates, community advocates, and local law enforcement agencies that worked on this bill. I move that we engross the bill and pass it to a third reading. The delegate from Scott County, Delegate Kilgore. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speak to the bill. Delegate has the floor. Again, Mr. Speaker, if this is intended to apply to federal ICE agents or any federal agency, it's a violation of the Supremacy Clause.

[02:10:19] I hope that we realize that as we're voting on a lot of these bills. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Over on page 42, we come to House Bill 1492. This is legislation amended and reenacted Section of the Code of Virginia related to impersonating federal law enforcement officer penalties. The Legislation Report Committee on Public Safety with amendment nature substitute. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Shin. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move adoption of the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitutes agree to thank you mr. speaker mr. speaker house bill 1492 will

[02:10:58] establish a class 6 felony for the impersonation of a federal law enforcement officer a class 5 for a second or subsequent offense it also establishes a classified felony for anyone impersonating a federal law enforcement officer while masked with a class 4 felony for a second or subsequent offense and mr. speaker I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading all those in favor say aye those opposed no the bill is engrossed pass the third reading. And finally, we come to House Bill 1525. Legislation amend and reenact sections code of Virginia later in to purchase, possession, or transportation of certain firearms

[02:11:34] by persons younger than 21 years of age penalty. This legislation report committee on public safety with amendment nature substitute. The delegate from Alexandria, Delegate McGuire. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. Committee substitute is agreed to.

[02:11:52] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, HB 1525 makes it unlawful for any person under 21 to knowingly and intentionally purchase a handgun or assault firearm. HB 1525 is in line with the historical restrictions placed on 18 to 20 year olds from purchasing a firearm.

[02:12:09] And this was confirmed in a Fourth Circuit Court of Appeals decision last June in McCoy versus ATF, where a federal prohibition on purchasing handguns for 18 to 20 year olds was unsuccessfully challenged. Mr. Speaker, I hope it's the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Delegate from Campbell County, Delegate Zier.

[02:12:26] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Question for the patron. Would a delegate yield for a question? The delegate will yield. Delegate will yield. Thank you. I'm wondering, am I understanding this correctly, that an 18-year-old can be issued an M4 by the Army but can't possess a pistol in his own home?

[02:12:41] Mr. Speaker, I would answer the delegate that in the bill it clearly states this is for the purchase of a firearm, not possession. Delegate from Campbell County, Delegate Zier. Thank you. Follow-up question. I'm wondering how does this square with the Bruin test for historical— With the Delegate yield for an additional question.

[02:12:59] I'm sorry. Mr. Speaker, I'll yield. The Delegate yield. Thank you. I'm wondering how this squares up with the Bruin test for historical precedent at the time of the founding. Delegate from Alexandria. Mr. Speaker, I would answer the Delegate that the ultimate goal of this bill is to save lives.

[02:13:16] There is recent court decisions in the Fourth Circuit Court that says this is a constitutionally viable bill. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. shall the bill be engrossing past the third reading all those in favor say aye those opposed no the bill's engrossing past the third reading mr speaker members of the house new uh new category a resolution's uncontested calendar the uncontested uh resolution calendar on page 42 begins with

[02:13:52] house joint resolution 23 designating august in 2026 and in each succeeding year as make a will month in virginia legislation reporting on rules delegate from newport news delegate price yes uh Speaking to the resolution, Mr. Speaker.

[02:14:10] Duggan has the floor. Yes, we found that many myths exist around the process of making a will, and we hope to use August as an opportunity to help educate Virginians that everyone should have a will or trust in place to help protect their financial future of their family, how to go about that process, and the free resources available to help.

[02:14:28] I hope that we will pass the resolution. Next up in the block is House Student Resolution 24, designating August in 2026, and in each succeeding year as Immunization Awareness Month in Virginia, this legislation also report committee on rules. Delegate for Newport News, Delegate Price. Mr. Speaker, an alarming number of diseases and conditions that we thought had been eradicated are coming back. Due to misinformation, many people are confused about the truth and science about vaccines, their purpose, their process, the suggested schedule, and real risk-benefit analysis. To that end, we hope to use August to educate the public widely about the benefits of immunizations so we can keep our children and communities safe. I hope we will pass the

[02:15:04] resolution. Next up in the block is House Joint Resolution number 25. This one designates the third for a week of October in 2026 and each succeeding year as non-apparent Disabilities Awareness Week in Virginia. This legislation again reporting committee on rules. The delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Thank you Mr. Speaker did you know you can't always tell a person's disability just by looking at them? Well that is what we hope to teach during non-apparent Disabilities Awareness Week so that we can get rid of the stigma of disabilities and help educate others to the different types of disabilities people face and the supports they may need. This could hopefully lead to a greater pride in ourselves, to benefit from wider acceptance and support, and to

[02:15:44] participate more fully in our communities. We also hope to uplift the amazing work of the Disability Law Center of Virginia as they seek to make Virginia a more inclusive and accessible place. I hope that we will pass the resolution. House joint resolution 28 is by for the Therefore, continuing with the uncontested calendar block, we come to House Joint Resolution 32, directing the Joint Legislative Audit and Review Commission to study artificial intelligence use policies in place at institutions of higher education in the Commonwealth report.

[02:16:15] Legislation was reported on rules with amendments. Delegate from Albemarle, Delegate Laufer. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. H.J. 32 directs JLARC to study the policies regarding artificial intelligence in places at institutions of higher education in the Commonwealth.

[02:16:32] This study will help inform our higher education institutions on how to best adapt to technological evolutions. It will also advise them on how to prepare students for the rapidly changing workforce. Mr. Speaker, I move the adoption of the resolution.

[02:16:48] Mr. Newham, do you need to do the amendments? Move the amendments. Sorry. Forgive me. Mr. Speaker, I move the committee amendments. Yes. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to. All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no.

[02:17:03] The committee amendment is agreed to. Does the bill do everything that you said after the committee amendment? Yes. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the adoption of the resolution as amended. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, continuing with the block, uncontested block. House Joint Resolution 33, now before you, designates April in 2026, and each succeeding year is Myocarditis Awareness Month in Virginia.

[02:17:24] This legislation is reported committing on rules. From Chesapeake, Duncan Hayes. Mr. Speaker, can we go by temporarily on this? Without objection, H.J. 33 goes by temporarily. Thank you. Continuing over on page 46, House Joint Resolution 36.

[02:17:43] Now, before you would designate August 1 in 2026 in each succeeding year as Internet Safety and Online Predator Awareness Day. Legislation Report Committee on Rules. Deb from Lynchburg, Deb, you're welcome. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. H.J. 36 designates August 1st each year as the Internet Safety and Online Predator Awareness Day in Virginia.

[02:18:05] The Internet is an essential part of our daily life, but it also creates real risk, especially for children and seniors. This resolution encourages families, schools, law enforcement, and community organizations to work together to educate Virginians on how to stay safe online and recognize warnings before the harm occurs.

[02:18:28] Protecting our kids, our seniors, and our communities online, and I would move the adoption of this resolution. Next up in the block, we come to House Short Resolution 47. House Short Resolution 47 would designate May 21st in 2026, and in each succeeding year as Eliza Courtright Monroe Hay Day in Virginia.

[02:18:49] This is the Legislature Report Committee on Rules. Delegate from Virginia Beach, Delegate Tater. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. H.J. 47 designates May 21st as Eliza Courtright Monroe Hay Day in Virginia. By doing so, we honor a president's daughter.

[02:19:05] We also honor a Virginian who defined herself through her devotion to family, her resilience in the face of poverty, and her service to the vulnerable. I move that we move this resolution. House Joint Resolution 77 has been taken care of, therefore it's out of the block.

[02:19:23] Therefore, continuing with the block, we come to House Joint Resolution 78, which it would designate September in 2006, and each succeeding year is Pulmonary Fibrosis Awareness Month in Virginia. The Legislation report is pretty on rules. Delegate from Richmond, Delegate Cuthins. - Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[02:19:38] H.J. 78 designates September of each year as Pulmonary Fibrosis Awareness Month in Virginia. Pulmonary fibrosis is a deadly lung-scarring disease with no true cure and limited treatment options. Nearly 50,000 people in the United States are diagnosed with the disease each year.

[02:19:55] Designating September as Pulmonary Fibrosis Awareness Month provides an opportunity for all Virginians to learn more about the disease and to support research into treatments and a cure. Mr. Speaker, I move adoption of the resolution.

[02:20:11] - Ms. Speaker, continuing with the uncontested calendar block we come to House Joint Resolution 87, designating April 13th in 2026 and in each succeeding year as day of remembrance for victims of lynching in Virginia.

[02:20:26] Legislation reporting committee on rules. - Doug from Richmond City, Delegate McQuinn. - Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, H.J.R. 87 designate April the 13th for each year as the Day of Remembrance for victims of lynching in Virginia. This resolution honored the memory of individuals who were brutally killed by mobs and acts of lynching, acts of racial terror that had deeply scarred families and communities across our commonwealth.

[02:20:51] Lynching was not only a crime, it was an instrument of terror used to oppress and instill fear, especially within African-American communities in the decades following the Civil War. By formally recognizing this day, we acknowledge the painful chapter of Virginia's history so that they are never forgotten nor repeated.

[02:21:10] This is not about assigning blame for the past, but about solemn remembrance, truth, and reconciliation. It is about recognizing the humanity of those whose lives were taken in such senseless violence and reaffirming our shared commitment to justice and equality.

[02:21:26] Designating this day also aligns with the ongoing work of the Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. Memorial Commission, which recommend this remembrance as a part of Virginia's broad-up effort to confront its history with courage and honesty. This resolution carries no fiscal impact on the Commonwealth.

[02:21:42] It is a statement of our value, a declaration that we will honor those lost to lynching by remembering their names, their stories, and the lesson we must carry forward. I move, Mr. Speaker, the adoption of this resolution. Next up in the block is House Grant Resolution 89, designating May 9th in 2026, in each succeeding year as Long QT Syndrome Awareness Day in Virginia.

[02:22:06] This legislation, again, reported by the Committee on Rules. Doug, from Henry County, Doug Phillips. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HJR 89 designates May 9, 2026 in each succeeding year as Long QT Syndrome Awareness Day. Long QT Syndrome is a genetic or acquired electrical or physioelectrical heart issue with dangerous arrhythmias, fainting, or sudden death.

[02:22:28] One in 10 patients may experience cardiac arrest or sudden death as their first symptom. My wife actually passed away from this in her early 20s, and both of my two sons were diagnosed with it. So this is very personal to me. My youngest son, Tanner, actually has a defibrillator implanted in his chest.

[02:22:48] Thank God our grandchildren, none of them have been diagnosed with it, and they're all healthy and doing well. They've learned a lot about this disease, and I just want to bring awareness to it. So thank you for helping me raise awareness about a disease that has affected my family. So profoundly and personally, and I move the adoption of the resolution.

[02:23:03] And Mr. Speaker, returning to page 45, we pick up Delegate Hayes' House Joint Resolution 33. House Joint Resolution 33 would designate April in 2026, and each succeeding year as Myocarditis

Awareness Month in Virginia.

[02:23:32] The Legislation Report Committee on Rules. From Chesapeake, Delegate Hayes. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, House Joint Resolution 33, as described by the clerk, will designate April as Myocarditis Awareness Month. Myocarditis is a rare infectious disease that causes inflammation of the cardiac muscle and may result in severe cardiovascular symptoms or even heart failure.

[02:23:55] Mr. Speaker, I move that we accept the resolution. Shall the resolutions be agreed to? Clerk will close the row.

[02:24:13] Ayes. 90. Oh, got to destroy the row. Clerk, destroy the row. She had this 1HJ. There we go. So the resolutions we agreed to. Clerk will close the roll.

[02:24:36] Ayes 97, no zero. Ayes 97, no zero. The resolutions are agreed to. And finally, we come to the last category of today's calendar, page 48, resolutions regular calendar. Resolutions regular calendar. First, we come to House Joint Resolution, excuse me, Senate Joint Resolution 60, confirming appointments by the governor of certain persons communicated to the General Assembly January 21, 2026.

[02:24:59] This legislation reported to the Committee on Privileges and Elections with an amendment. Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Joint Resolution 60 is from the new governor for her cabinet appointments.

[02:25:18] There is a committee amendment I would like to move that is on the request of the Secretary. And so I would move the committee amendment. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The committee amendment is agreed to. And now I would move adoption of the resolution. Mr. Speaker? The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon.

[02:25:36] Mr. Speaker, I would rise to request that we sever the appointee on lines 13 and 14 of the resolution and vote on that number separately so that the member of the body can abstain. Mr. Boulevard.

[02:25:59] Shall the resolution be agreed to, with the exception of line 13 and 14? Clerk will close the roll.

[02:26:20] Ayes, 94, nose, 1. Ayes, 94, nose, 1. The resolution is agreed to. Go back and do. shall lines 13 and 14 of SJ61 be agreed to?

[02:26:44] Clerk, close the row. Ayes 93, noes 0, abstentions 1.

[02:27:02] Ayes 93, noes 0, abstentions 1. And, Ms. Speaker, the last resolution in this category, Senate Joint Resolution 61. This resolution confirms appointments by the governor of certain persons to the General Assembly on January 23rd, 2026.

[02:27:24] This resolution, again, was reported on privileges and elections. Delegate Price. Yes, Mr. Speaker, this is Senate Joint Resolution 61, and this is more of Her Excellency's appointees. I move that we would adopt the resolution. Shall the resolution be agreed to?

[02:27:44] Clerk will close the row. Ayes 64, no zero. Ayes 64, no zero. The resolution is agreed to. Ms. Speaker, that completes today's calendar.

[02:28:04] Per House Rule 51, the House has returned to the morning hour. Does the clerk have any additional announcements or communications? No communication, simply the meeting schedule announcement as we approach crossover, busy days ahead this Wednesday afternoon.

[02:28:20] Immediately upon adjournment of the House, here shortly at 2.30ish, the Committee on Privileges and Elections is going to be meeting in House Committee Room A in the lower level. So P&E, off cycle, a meeting in House Committee Room A, immediately upon adjournment of the House. Then 15 minutes upon adjournment of the House, Committee on Appropriations Subcommittee is one.

[02:28:42] There are five subcommittees of Appropriations that are going to meet sequentially before the full committee does. All the meetings will be over in the General Assembly Building on the 12th floor. First off, 15 minutes upon adjournment, we'll have Appropriations, Commerce, Ag, and Natural Resources sub. Once they're finished, then Appropriations, Transportation, and Public Safety Subcommittee, and then Appropriations, Health and Human Resources Subcommittee, followed then by the elementary and secondary subcommittee, and finally the general government and capital outlay.

[02:29:10] So five subcommittees will just meet all in the Appropriations Committee room, and then the Committee on Appropriations will meet once the last one is finished, all on the 12th floor. The Committee on Finance will meet 15 minutes after adjournment of the House. Committee on Finance, they'll be in the House Committee room B on the second floor.

[02:29:28] The Courts of Justice Committee will meet 15 minutes upon adjournment of the Finance Committee. They'll be in House Committee Room C next door. And then once the full courts committee is finished, then its criminal sub will meet 15 minutes adjournment of the full committee.

[02:29:44] And they will be in the House Committee Room C, the same one. And then the court civil subcommittee will meet 15 minutes upon adjournment of the full committee. But they'll be down the hall in the north subcommittee room. And the two other subcommittee meetings, one of transportation, one of ACNR, those are canceled today.

[02:30:03] Then the last meeting, caucus meetings, LGBTQ, it's listed, the LGBTQIA plus caucus meeting at 5 in the 9th floor subcommittee room. And if there are any changes to that, just check the calendar.

[02:30:21] Looking ahead to tomorrow, February 12th, Capitol Commission prayer meeting begins at 6.30, followed by the Bible study at 7. That'll be in the Speaker's Conference Room up on the 14th floor of the General Assembly Building. The Legislative Sportsman Caucus, they'll be meeting tomorrow at 7.

[02:30:37] They'll be on the 7th floor North Meeting Room. That's the Sportsman's Caucus. The Hampton Roads Caucus is meeting at 7.30. They'll be in the 7th floor South Subcommittee Meeting Room. The Health and Human Services and Behavioral Health Subcommittee will meet at 7.30 tomorrow.

[02:30:56] They'll be in House Committee Room C, and then once they've finished their docket, Then the full committee will meet at 8.30 on the second floor of House Committee Room C. And the Health Professions subcommittee will not be meeting. So just one sub and then the full committee on that at 7.30.

[02:31:12] Excuse me. Looking ahead, or tomorrow as well, at 7.30, Public Safety Subcommittee No. 2 is meeting at 7.30. They're going to be in the House North Subcommittee Room. Then we have several caucus meetings later in the morning.

[02:31:31] Aviation caucus will meet at 8 a.m. in the Senate subcommittee room on the 6th floor. So that'll be aviation caucus, Senate subcommittee room 600 north. Then the sickle cell anemia caucus, they'll be meeting at 8. They'll be in House subcommittee room 9 or the House committee meeting at 9.

[02:31:48] Excuse me, on the 9th floor. That meeting is at 8 o'clock. The committee on transportation meets at 9 o'clock tomorrow in House committee room B. And they will work through their docket. And then, lastly, the two caucuses we'll be meeting before we go into session. Democratic caucus meeting at 11.15 tomorrow in House Committee Room 1.

[02:32:05] The Republicans at 11 a.m. in House Committee Room 2. The Speaker, all the meeting agendas listed in the House meeting schedule. And I apologize for my other voice. Delegate from Richmond City, Delegate Cousins. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I ask that we return to the first morning hour for an introduction.

[02:32:23] Delegate has the floor. Thank you. In the gallery, patiently waiting, are participants in the annual Advocacy Day for Virginia Housing Alliance, which is celebrating its 10th anniversary this year. And I ask that the remaining members please rise.

[02:32:39] They started off 80 strong, but... The organization traces its roots back over 40 years to the Virginia Housing Coalition and Virginia Coalition to End Homelessness, with the Virginia Housing Alliance, often referred to as VHA, formed through their merger in January 2016.

[02:32:57] For the past decade, VHA has focused on expanding affordable housing opportunities and ending homelessness in Virginia through advocacy, education, and capacity building. More than 25,000 Virginians have a safe, affordable place to call home as a result of the Virginia Housing Alliance and its members' tireless efforts.

[02:33:15] I want to thank VHA for joining us today and for their work to ensure that all Virginians have an affordable place to call home. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. And I request that the members join me in extending a warm house welcome. We got a different definition of brief.

[02:33:44] The delegate from Roanoke City, Delegate Rasul. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I ask that we stay in the first morning hour for the purpose of a brief introduction. Oh, my God. The delegate from Roanoke, Delegate Rasul. Thank you. That's a lot of paragraphs. I can see that from here. I crossed most of it out.

[02:34:00] Okay, the delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The Virginia Statewide Transition Leaders Academy could please rise. They've been waiting patiently. They have. They are a nonprofit organization dedicated to improving post-secondary transition experiences and outcomes for young Virginians with disabilities.

[02:34:19] They wrap around them all year long. We talk about kids in school, students with disabilities, but they think about what happens after school. Their work is important to all of us here in Virginia. I hope we can give them a warm house welcome.

[02:34:39] Welcome, welcome, welcome to the Capitol. That was almost worth the wait. That was a good one. The Delegate from Alexander, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that when the House adjourns today, adjourn to reconvene tomorrow at 12 noon.

[02:34:57] The Delegate from Alexander, Delegate Herring, moves that when the House adjourns today, adjourn to reconvene tomorrow at 12 noon. as many in favor the motion say aye aye those opposed no the motion is agreed to the delegate from alexandria delegate hearing mr speaker i move that the house do now adjourn the delegate from alexander who moves at the house who now adjourned as many in favor motion say aye those opposed no motion is agreed to the house turns adjourned until tomorrow at 12 noon



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